

SpaceCDF — Course Workbook

Self-paced worksheets, exercises and reflections to accompany the SpaceCDF textbook

SpaceCDF

2026

Note to the Learner

This workbook is the companion volume to the *SpaceCDF Textbook*. It is designed to be used by you, alone or in a study team, at your own pace — no facilitator or instructor is required. Each chapter contains worksheets, calculations to perform, and reflections to write. Hints direct you back to the textbook chapter that introduces the underlying theory.

When the workbook mentions the SpaceCDF tool, you should have a working installation in front of you (see the *SpaceCDF Installation Guide*). The tool runs entirely on your own computer; instructions for navigation are written so that you can perform the steps without supervision.

Spaces marked with a thin pencil rule are intended for your own notes. There are no marking rubrics in this volume.

Acknowledgement — Generative AI (AIG)

This workbook was produced with the assistance of generative AI as part of the SpaceCDF Concurrent Design Facility workflow. The worksheet content, calculation prompts, equation sheets and embedded figures are generated by the SpaceCDF toolchain (Python · matplotlib · python-docx) guided by ECSS, NASA SEH and SMAD-4 references. Editorial framing and pedagogical commentary remain owned by the SpaceCDF teaching team.

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Any course deliverable that you produce based on this workbook — or any document exported by SpaceCDF — must carry the AIG badge and a short note describing how generative AI was used. Refusing to use AI where it is permitted is fine; what is not acceptable is using it without saying so.

Worksheet 1.1: Introduction to Space Mission Design

Name:	-----
Date:	-----
Team:	-----
Session:	1.1 -- Introduction to Space Mission Design

Part A: The 17 SE Processes -- SpaceCDF Mapping

For each NASA SE process (NPR 7123.1D), identify which SpaceCDF feature implements it. Write the tab name, button, or panel. If the process requires human judgment that the tool cannot automate, mark "Manual" in the last column.

Hint: Navigate through SpaceCDF's workflow steps (Step 1 Mission Need • Step 2 Concept • Step 3 Requirements • Step 4 Design) and explore each tab. Many processes map to more than one feature.

#	SE Process	SpaceCDF Feature(s)	Manual?
1	Stakeholder Expectations Definition	-----	_____
2	Technical Requirements Definition	-----	_____
3	Logical Decomposition	-----	_____
4	Design Solution Definition	-----	_____
5	Product Implementation	-----	_____
6	Product Integration	-----	_____
7	Product Verification	-----	_____
8	Product Validation	-----	_____
9	Product Transition	-----	_____
10	Technical Planning	-----	_____
11	Requirements Management	-----	_____
12	Interface Management	-----	_____
13	Technical Risk Management	-----	_____
14	Configuration Management	-----	_____
15	Technical Data Management	-----	_____
16	Technical Assessment	-----	_____
17	Decision Analysis	-----	_____

Reflection: Which processes are well-supported by the tool? Which ones fundamentally require human judgment and cannot be fully automated? Write your answer below:

Part B: Lifecycle Phase Identification

For each activity below, identify which NASA lifecycle phase (Pre-A through F) it belongs to and which review gate marks the end of that phase:

Activity	NASA Phase	Review Gate
"We need to monitor sea ice thickness in the Canadian Arctic"	----	----
Writing system-level "shall" requirements with verification methods	----	----
Selecting a specific reaction wheel vendor after evaluating 3 options	----	----
Running thermal-vacuum qualification tests on the flight model	----	----
Operating the satellite and producing daily data products	----	----
Decommissioning the satellite and performing passivation	----	----
Preliminary orbit trade study comparing SSO, ISS-orbit, and polar	----	----
Detailed finite element analysis of the primary structure	----	----

Hint: Refer to the lifecycle phase table in Session 1.1, Section 4.3. Consider: What level of design detail does this activity require?

Part C: CDF Position Interaction Analysis

For each design conflict below, identify which engineering positions must interact to resolve it. Then briefly describe how you would approach the resolution.

Conflict 1: The payload requires 50 W but the solar array can only provide 30 W.

Positions involved: _____

Resolution approach: _____

Conflict 2: The reaction wheel vibration exceeds the payload's pointing stability requirement.

Positions involved: _____

Resolution approach: _____

Conflict 3: The selected orbit (700 km) requires a propulsive deorbit for debris compliance, but there is no mass budget remaining for a propulsion system.

Positions involved: _____

Resolution approach: _____

Conflict 4: The X-band downlink antenna pattern interferes with the payload's sensitive optical receiver.

Positions involved: _____

Resolution approach: _____

Part D: SpaceCDF Tool Exploration

Navigate through the SpaceCDF tool and answer each question:

1. How many KPI cards are shown on the Design Dashboard? List them by name:

1. In the Gate Review tab, what are the MCR exit criteria? Which are auto-evaluated?

1. What engineering positions are available when starting a collaborative session?

1. What workflow steps does SpaceCDF guide you through (from left to right)?

1. In the Positions tab, find your assigned position. What key questions does it list?

Part E: V-Model Sketch

In the space below, sketch the System-V model from memory. Label each level on both the left side (decomposition) and right side (integration). Draw the horizontal traceability arrows and label them.

Use this space for your sketch:

Notes & Reflections

Record key points below, questions you want to follow up on, and connections to your mission concept:

Worksheet 1.2: Canadian Space Ecosystem & Regulatory Environment

Name:	-----
Date:	-----
Team:	-----
Session:	1.2 -- Canadian Space Ecosystem & Regulatory Environment

Part A: Canadian Space Industry Mapping

For your team's mission concept, identify potential Canadian industry partners at each tier. If no Canadian supplier exists for a capability, note what country you would source from and why.

Tier	Capability Needed	Canadian Candidate(s)	International Alternative	Justification
Tier 1 (Prime/Integration)	---	---	---	---
Tier 2 (Subsystem)	---	---	---	---
Tier 2 (Subsystem)	---	---	---	---
Tier 3 (Component/Service)	---	---	---	---
Tier 4 (R&D/Academic)	---	---	---	---

Question: What CSA funding program(s) might support your mission? Why?

Part B: RSSSA Compliance Assessment

Answer the following questions for your team's mission concept:

1. Does your mission involve any remote sensing of Earth (imaging, SAR, radiometry, etc.)?

1. If yes, will the satellite be operated from Canada?

1. What RSSSA conditions might apply? (Check all that apply)

Condition	Applies?	Notes
Priority access for Government of Canada	----	---
Shutter control provisions	----	---
Data disposition / handling plan	----	---
System disposal plan	----	---
Raw data protection	----	---
Interoperability arrangements (foreign access)	----	---

1. If your mission does NOT involve remote sensing, what other regulatory requirements apply? (e.g., spectrum licensing, export control)

Part C: Spectrum Licensing Plan

Identify the frequency bands your mission will use and the licensing path for each:

Link	Band	Frequency (GHz)	Data Rate	Use (TT&C / Payload / ISL)	Licensing Path
Uplink	----	----	----	----	----
Downlink (TT&C)	----	----	----	----	----
Downlink (Payload)	----	----	----	----	----
Other	----	----	----	----	----

Hint: For a typical CubeSat, TT&C uses S-band (2.0--2.3 GHz) and payload data uses X-band (8.025--8.4 GHz). The licensing path for each is: ISED application -> ISED technical review -> ITU filing (API) -> ITU coordination -> ISED licence issuance.

Question: How early in your project should you begin the spectrum licensing process? Why?

Part D: Export Control Classification

List the 3 most critical components in your preliminary mission concept. For each, identify the likely export control classification:

Component	Country of Origin	Likely Classification	Licence Required?
---	----	ECCN: _ / USML Cat: _	----
---	----	ECCN: _ / USML Cat: _	----
---	----	ECCN: _ / USML Cat: _	----

Hint: Most commercial-off-the-shelf (COTS) space components from US manufacturers are classified under EAR (ECCN 9A515 for spacecraft parts). Military-grade or specifically designed items may fall under ITAR (USML Category XV). Canadian-origin components are subject to EIPA if they appear on the Export Control List.

Question: If your mission includes a US-origin star tracker and you plan to launch on an Indian PSLV, what export control issues arise?

Part E: Regulatory Timeline

Based on your mission concept, estimate when each regulatory activity should begin and how long it will take. Mark the activities on the timeline below:

Regulatory Activity	Start Phase	Duration	Critical Path?
RSSSA licence application	----	----	----
ISED spectrum application	----	----	----
ITU coordination	----	----	----
Export permit(s)	----	----	----
Launch provider interface agreement	----	----	----

Question: Which regulatory activity is most likely to be on the critical path for your mission? Why?

Notes & Reflections

Record key points below, regulatory questions you need to research further, and implications for your mission design:

Worksheet 1.3: International Standards for Space Systems

Name:	-----
Date:	-----
Team:	-----
Session:	1.3 -- International Standards for Space Systems

Part A: Standard Applicability Matrix

For your team's mission concept, determine which ECSS and NASA standards apply. For each standard, decide whether it is fully applicable, partially applicable (with tailoring), or not applicable. Justify your decision.

Standard	Branch	Applicability	Tailoring Notes / Justification
ECSS-M-ST-10C (Project Management)	M	----	-----
ECSS-M-ST-40C (Configuration Management)	M	----	-----
ECSS-M-ST-80C (Risk Management)	M	----	-----
ECSS-E-ST-10C (Systems Engineering)	E	----	-----
ECSS-E-ST-20C (Electrical & Electronic)	E	----	-----
ECSS-E-ST-32C (Structures)	E	----	-----
ECSS-E-ST-40C (Software)	E	----	-----
ECSS-E-ST-50C (Communications)	E	----	-----
ECSS-Q-ST-10C (Product Assurance)	Q	----	-----
ECSS-U-AS-10C (Debris Mitigation)	U	----	-----
ISO 24113 (Debris Mitigation)	--	----	-----
NPR 7123.1D (SE Processes)	--	----	-----

Hint: A university CubeSat mission would typically invoke ECSS-E-ST-10C with heavy tailoring, ECSS-U-AS-10C fully, and might waive ECSS-Q-ST-10C (product assurance) due to cost constraints. A CSA-funded mission would typically require more complete ECSS compliance.

Question: What is the minimum set of standards your mission MUST comply with regardless of mission class?

Part B: CDS Rev 14 Compliance Checklist

If your mission uses a CubeSat form factor, complete this compliance checklist. If not, skip to Part C.

CDS Requirement	Your Design Value	Compliant?	Notes
Unit dimensions (100 x 100 x 113.5 mm per U)	----	----	----
Mass per U (≤ 2.0 kg)	----	----	----
Total mass (for your form factor)	----	----	----
Rail material (hard-anodised Al)	----	----	----
CG within 2 cm of geometric centre	----	----	----
No protrusions beyond envelope during launch	----	----	----
RF silence for 30 min after deployment	----	----	----
Deployment switches on all deployables	----	----	----
Propulsion inhibits (3 independent, if applicable)	----	----	----

Hint: Use SpaceCDF's Compliance panel to check CDS compliance. The tool will flag non-compliant parameters automatically based on your mass and dimensions entries.

Part C: Debris Mitigation Compliance

Complete the following debris mitigation assessment for your mission orbit:

1. **Planned orbit altitude:** ____ km

2. **Estimated natural orbital lifetime** (without propulsion):

Use the rule of thumb: $\tau_{\text{years}} \approx \frac{h-200}{30} \times \frac{m/A}{50}$ where h is altitude (km), m is mass (kg), A is cross-section area (m^2)

$h =$ _ **km**, $m =$ _ kg, $A =$ ____ m^2

$m/A =$ ____ kg/m^2

$\tau =$ ____ years (approximate)

1. **Compliance assessment:**

Requirement	Limit	Your Mission	Compliant?
IADC post-mission lifetime	≤ 25 years	----	----
FCC post-mission lifetime (2024+)	≤ 5 years	----	----
ISO 24113 disposal reliability	$\geq 90\%$	----	----

1. **If non-compliant with the 5-year FCC rule, what options exist?**

1. **Passivation plan** (list all stored energy sources and how you will deplete them at end of life):

Energy Source	Passivation Method
Battery	-----
Pressure vessels (if any)	-----
Reaction wheels	-----
RF transmitter	-----
Other: _____	-----

Part D: Structural Design Margins

If your mission has preliminary structural design information, calculate the margin of safety:

Use the formula: $MoS = \frac{\sigma_{allowable}}{FoS \times \sigma_{applied}} - 1$

Worked example: For Al 7075-T6 ($\sigma_{yield} = 503$ MPa), applied stress = 200 MPa, FoS (yield) = 1.25:

$$MoS = \frac{503}{1.25 \times 200} - 1 = \frac{503}{250} - 1 = 1.012$$

This is a positive margin (compliant).

Your calculation:

Material: _ , $\sigma_{allowable} =$ _ MPa

$\sigma_{applied} =$ _ **MPa**, **FoS** = _

MoS = _____ (show work below)

Part E: SpaceCDF Compliance Panel

Navigate to the Compliance panel in SpaceCDF and answer:

1. What is the debris mitigation compliance status for your mission?

1. What orbital altitude would be needed to comply with the FCC 5-year rule WITHOUT propulsion?
(Use the tool's orbital lifetime calculator)

1. What standards has the tool automatically suggested for your mission type?

1. Are there any compliance flags (warnings or errors) on your current design?

Notes & Reflections

Record key points about standards applicability, compliance challenges, and design implications for your mission:

Worksheet 1.4: Mission Needs, Trade Studies & Concept of Operations

Name:	-----
Date:	-----
Team:	-----
Session:	1.4 -- Mission Needs, Trade Studies & ConOps

Part A: Stakeholder Analysis Matrix

Identify at least 4 stakeholders for your team's mission. For each, capture their needs, constraints, priority, and influence level.

#	Stakeholder	Role	Key Needs	Constraints Imposed	Priority (P/S/T)	Influence (H/M/L)
1	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
2	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
3	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
4	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
5	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
6	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

P = Primary (must satisfy), S = Secondary (should satisfy), T = Tertiary (nice to have) H = High influence, M = Medium, L = Low

Question: Which stakeholder has the most influence over your mission? Do any stakeholders have conflicting needs? If so, how might you resolve the conflict?

Part B: Problem Statement

Write your team's mission problem statement. It must answer all four questions: What is the problem? Who is affected? What is the impact? What constraints exist?

Problem Statement:

Peer Review Checklist (exchange with another team):

Criterion	Pass?	Feedback
Describes WHAT is needed, not HOW to achieve it?	_____	_____
Identifies the capability gap?	_____	_____
Names specific affected stakeholders?	_____	_____
Quantifies the impact of not solving it?	_____	_____
States constraints (budget, schedule, regulatory)?	_____	_____
Free of solution language? (No specific satellite type, orbit, component named)	_____	_____

Part C: Mission Objectives

Write 2--3 mission objectives. Score each against the quality checklist.

Objective 1: _____

Quality Criterion	Yes/No	Notes
States WHAT, not HOW?	_____	_____
Has measurable criterion with number + unit?	_____	_____
Achievable with current technology (TRL $\geq$ 4)?	_____	_____
Relevant to the problem statement?	_____	_____
Traceable to a specific stakeholder need?	_____	_____
Classified as primary or secondary?	_____	_____

Objective 2: _____

Quality Criterion	Yes/No	Notes
States WHAT, not HOW?	_____	_____
Has measurable criterion with number + unit?	_____	_____
Achievable with current technology (TRL $\geq$ 4)?	_____	_____
Relevant to the problem statement?	_____	_____
Traceable to a specific stakeholder need?	_____	_____
Classified as primary or secondary?	_____	_____

Objective 3 (optional): _____

Part D: MoE / MoP / TPM Trace

For your primary objective, trace the measurement hierarchy:

Objective: _____

MoE (Measure of Effectiveness -- operational effectiveness from user perspective):

MoP (Measure of Performance -- technical performance of the system):

TPM (Technical Performance Measure -- design parameter tracked during development):

Hint: If your objective is "Provide 10 m GSD multispectral imagery...", then: - MoE might be "% of target area with usable (<30% cloud) imagery within 5 days" - MoP might be " $GSD \leq 10$ m at nadir, $SNR \geq 100$ in all bands" - TPM might be "current estimate of aperture diameter (target: 15 cm), imager mass (target: 1.5 kg)"

Part E: Trade Study -- Space vs Non-Space

Complete a trade study evaluating whether a dedicated satellite is the right solution for your mission need.

Decision statement: _____

Alternatives:

#	Alternative	Description
1	_____	_____
2	_____	_____
3	_____	_____
4	Do nothing / status quo	_____

Criteria and Weights (must sum to 1.0):

Use pairwise comparison or direct assignment. Show your weight derivation below.

Criterion	Weight	Direction (higher/lower is better)
_____	_____	---
_____	_____	---

Criterion	Weight	Direction (higher/lower is better)
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
Total	1.00	

Weight derivation (pairwise comparison table or notes):

Scoring Matrix (normalised 0--1):

Alternative	Criterion 1	Criterion 2	Criterion 3	Criterion 4	Criterion 5	Weighted Total
1: _____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
2: _____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
3: _____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
4: Do nothing	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Recall: $Weighted\ Total = \sum w_c \times s(a, c)$

Result: The highest-scoring alternative is: _____

Decision statement (1 paragraph -- include top 2 alternatives and why one was selected over the other):

Sensitivity check: If you increase the weight of your second-most-important criterion by 20% (and re-normalise), does the ranking change?

Part F: Concept of Operations Outline

Document your preliminary ConOps following the NASA SEH Appendix S structure:

1. Mission Architecture:

Space segment: _____

Ground segment: _____

User segment: _____

2. Orbit-Average Power Budget:

Calculate using: $P_{avg} = \sum P_{mode,i} \times DC_i$

Mode	Power (W)	Duty Cycle (fraction of orbit)	P x DC (W)
Idle / Housekeeping	----	----	----
Science / Imaging	----	----	----
Downlink	----	----	----
Eclipse	----	----	----
		Orbit-average power:	---- W

Solar array requirement: $P_{SA} = \text{---- W}$

Show your calculation:

3. Data Budget:

Daily data generation: ---- GB/day

Downlink capacity per pass: ---- GB/pass

Passes per day: ----

Daily downlink capacity: ---- GB/day

Balance (downlink $\geq$ generation)? ----

Part G: SpaceCDF Tool Entry

In SpaceCDF, enter your mission need (Step 1) and concept (Step 2). Then answer:

1. In Step 1, did the tool auto-detect your mission type from the objective text? What type did it suggest?

1. In Step 2, run the mission trade analysis. Does the tool's recommendation match your manual trade study result from Part E?

1. In the ConOps tab, build your architecture diagram. How many systems did you define?

1. In the Trade Studies tab, run an orbit selection trade with at least 3 orbit options. What orbit did it recommend?

Notes & Reflections

Record key decisions made today, open questions, and what you want to investigate further:

Worksheet 2.1: The System-V and Requirements Engineering

Name:	_____
Date:	_____
Team / Mission:	_____
Role / Position:	_____

SpaceCDF Tab: Requirements

Key Equations Reference

Traceability Coverage:

$$\text{Coverage} = \frac{N_{\text{verified requirements}}}{N_{\text{total requirements}}} \times 100\%$$

Target: 100% -- every requirement needs a parent trace, a verification method, and a responsible subsystem.

Requirement Quality (SMART): Specific -- Measurable -- Achievable -- Relevant -- Traceable

Verification Methods (ATID): Analysis -- Test -- Inspection -- Demonstration

Part A: System-V Mapping

For your mission, identify one element at each level of the V-model:

V-Level	Left Branch (Decomposition)	Right Branch (Verification)
Stakeholder Need		
Mission Requirement		
System Requirement		
Subsystem Requirement		

Part B: Requirement Quality Assessment

Evaluate each requirement using the SMART checklist and NASA Appendix C criteria. Mark Pass (P) or Fail (F). Rewrite any failures.

#	Requirement	S	M	A	R	T	WHAT or HOW?	Rewrite (if needed)
1	"The spacecraft shall operate at 500 km altitude"							
2	"The system shall achieve GSD <= 10 m at nadir"							
3	"The EPS shall use triple-junction GaAs cells"							
4	"The system shall have a design lifetime of at least 3 years"							
5	"The structure shall be made of aluminium 7075"							

Part C: Requirement Hierarchy and Traceability

For your mission, write one requirement at each level. Draw the traceability chain.

Stakeholder Objective (traces FROM): _____

Mission Requirement (MR-___): _____

System Requirement (SR-___), derived from MR above: _____

Subsystem Requirement (SSR-___), derived from SR above: ____

Traceability diagram (draw arrows showing parent-child relationships):

Part D: Splitting Compound Requirements

Split this compound requirement into individually testable statements:

"The system shall provide 10 m GSD multispectral imagery with 5-day revisit, 24-hour data latency, and positive power margin in all operational modes including eclipse."

#	Split Requirement (one concern each)	Type (F/P/I/C/E)	Verification (A/T/I/D)	Phase
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

Part E: SpaceCDF Requirements Generation

1. In SpaceCDF, click "**Generate from Objectives.**" How many requirements were generated? ____
2. Use the Level filter -- count at each level: - Mission: _ **System:** _ Subsystem: ____
3. Classify 5 requirements by type:

Req ID	Requirement Text (abbreviated)	Type (Functional / Performance / Interface / Constraint / Environmental)

1. Find one requirement that says HOW (implementation) not WHAT. Write it and your correction:

- **Original:** _____
- **Corrected:** _____

1. Accept at least 5 requirements and reject at least 1. Record your decisions:

Req ID	Action (Accept/Edit/Reject)	Rationale

1. For 5 key requirements, assign verification method and phase:

Req ID	Verification Method (A/T/I/D)	Phase (B/C/D/E)	Rationale for Method

Notes & Reflections

Worksheet 2.2: Functional Decomposition and Allocation

Name:	_____
Date:	_____
Team / Mission:	_____
Role / Position:	_____

SpaceCDF Tab: Functions

Key Equations Reference

Function Types: Observe, Communicate, Navigate, Point, Power, Protect, Store, Process, Support

Universal Functions (every spacecraft): 1. Generate electrical power 2. Maintain thermal environment 3. Survive launch environment 4. Communicate with ground (TTC) 5. Dispose at end of life

Coverage Rule: Every leaf function must trace to at least one requirement. No gaps.

Allocation Rule: Multi-allocated functions create interfaces that must be explicitly managed.

Part A: Mission Function Tree

Draw your mission's complete function tree. Use minimum 3 levels of decomposition. Include both mission-specific and universal functions.

Mission-specific functions:

```

F-001: _____
  +-- F-002: _____
    +-- F-002a: _____
    +-- F-002b: _____
  +-- F-003: _____
    +-- F-003a: _____
  +-- F-004: _____
  +-- F-005: _____
  
```

Universal functions:

```

F-010: Generate electrical power
  +-- F-011: _____
  +-- F-012: _____
F-020: Maintain thermal environment
  +-- F-021: _____
  
```

F-030: Survive launch environment
 F-040: Communicate with ground (TTC)
 F-050: Dispose at end of life

Part B: Function-to-Requirement Traceability

For each leaf function, write one derived requirement with a measurable threshold:

Function ID	Function Name	Allocated To (Subsystem)	Derived Requirement	Type

Part C: Multi-Allocation Analysis

Identify at least one function that is allocated to more than one subsystem:

Function: _____

Subsystem A (primary): _____

Subsystem B (contributor): _____

Interface created between A and B: _____

Who "owns" this function? _____

What interface requirements are needed? _____

Part D: Performance Criteria

For 4 key functions, define quantitative performance criteria:

Function	Performance Criterion	Value	Unit	Source

Part E: SpaceCDF Coverage Check

After entering functions in SpaceCDF:

- 1. How many total functions in your tree? ____
- 2. How many leaf functions? ____
- 3. How many leaf functions have NO linked requirements (amber badge)? ____
- 4. List the uncovered functions and derive requirements for them:

Function ID	Function Name	Derived Requirement

- 1. Are there any functions the tool generated that are NOT appropriate for your mission? List and explain why you removed them:

Notes & Reflections

Worksheet 2.3: Orbit Selection and Mission Architecture

Name:	_____
Date:	_____
Team / Mission:	_____
Role / Position:	_____

SpaceCDF Tabs: Mission Architecture, Orbit Trade Advisor

Key Equations Reference

Orbital period: $T = 2\pi\sqrt{a^3/\mu}$ where $a = R_E + h$, $\mu = 3.986 \times 10^{14} \text{ m}^3/\text{s}^2$, $R_E = 6371 \text{ km}$

Orbital velocity: $v = \sqrt{\mu/a}$

Eclipse fraction: $f_{\text{ecl}} = \frac{1}{\pi} \arccos\left(\frac{\sqrt{a^2 - R_E^2}}{a}\right)$

Sun-synchronous inclination: $\cos(i) = -\frac{2\dot{\Omega}a^{7/2}}{3R_E^2 J_2 \sqrt{\mu}}$ where $J_2 = 1.0826 \times 10^{-3}$

Hohmann ΔV : $\Delta V_1 = \sqrt{\mu/r_1} \left(\sqrt{2r_2/(r_1 + r_2)} - 1 \right)$

Swath width: $W = 2h \tan(\theta)$

Part A: Orbital Mechanics Calculations

Your selected orbit: Altitude $h = _ \text{ km}$, Inclination $i = \text{deg}$, Type: $_$

Show all working for each calculation:

1. Semi-major axis:

$$a = R_E + h = 6371 + _ = \text{km} = _ \text{ m}$$

2. Orbital period:

$$T = 2\pi\sqrt{a^3/\mu} = 2\pi\sqrt{_ ^3 / 3.986 \times 10^{14}} = \text{s}$$

$$= _ \text{ min}$$

3. Orbital velocity:

$$v = \sqrt{\mu/a} = \sqrt{3.986 \times 10^{14} / \text{ } } = \text{ } \text{ m/s}$$

4. Eclipse fraction (maximum):

$$f = \frac{1}{\pi} \arccos \left(\frac{\sqrt{a^2 - R_E^2}}{a} \right) = \frac{1}{\pi} \arccos (\text{ }) = \text{ } \text{ }$$

5. Sunlight and eclipse time per orbit:

$$t_{\text{sun}} = T \times (1 - f) = \text{ } \times \text{ } = \text{ } \text{ min}$$

$$t_{\text{ecl}} = T \times f = \text{ } \times \text{ } = \text{ } \text{ min}$$

6. Sun-synchronous inclination (if applicable):

$$\cos(i) = \text{ } \Rightarrow i = \text{ } \text{ deg}$$

Does this match your selected inclination? Y / N

Part B: Orbit Trade Matrix

From SpaceCDF's Orbit Trade Advisor, record the top 3 candidates:

Rank	Orbit Type	Alt (km)	Inc (deg)	GSD (m)	Revisit (d)	Natural Lifetime (yr)	FCC 5-yr?	Score
1								
2								
3								

Selected orbit: __ Rationale: _____

Part C: Debris Compliance

For your selected orbit:

Parameter	Value
Natural orbital lifetime	_____ years
FCC 5-year compliant?	Y / N
IADC 25-year compliant?	Y / N
Propulsion needed for deorbit?	Y / N
If yes, estimated deorbit ΔV	_____ m/s

Parameter	Value
Deorbit method (if needed)	-----

Show ΔV calculation if propulsion needed:

Part D: Downstream Cascade Analysis

How does your orbit selection affect each subsystem? Fill in the impact:

Subsystem	Orbit Parameter That Matters	Impact on Your Design
Payload (GSD)	Altitude = _____ km	GSD = _____ m
EPS (eclipse)	Eclipse fraction = _____	Eclipse duration = _____ min
Comms (link)	Slant range at 10 deg elev = _____ km	FSPL increase = _____ dB
Thermal	Eclipse/sunlight cycling	Hot case / Cold case concern: _____
AOCS	Orbit rate = _____ deg/min	Nadir tracking rate needed
Propulsion	Lifetime = _____ yr	Propulsion needed? Y / N
Radiation	TID estimate = _____ krad/yr	Electronics class: _____

Part E: Discussion

What would happen to your mission if you moved the orbit **100 km higher**?

What would happen if you moved it **100 km lower**?

Notes & Reflections



Worksheet 2.4: Mission Architecture -- Segments, Interfaces, and Budgets

Name:	_____
Date:	_____
Team / Mission:	_____
Role / Position:	_____

SpaceCDF Tabs: System Architecture, Interfaces, Dashboard, Budget Breakdown

Key Equations Reference

Mass margin: $\text{Margin}\% = \frac{M_{\text{alloc}} - M_{\text{MEV}}}{M_{\text{alloc}}} \times 100\%$ Green: > 20% | Amber: 10--20% | Red: < 10%

MEV: $M_{\text{MEV}} = M_{\text{CBE}} + \text{equipment margin} + \text{system margin}$

Orbit-average power: $P_{\text{avg}} = \sum (P_{\text{mode}} \times f_{\text{duty}})$

SA power: $P_{\text{SA}} = P_{\text{peak}} + \frac{P_{\text{ecl}} \times t_{\text{ecl}}}{t_{\text{sun}} \times \eta_{\text{charge}}}$

ECSS Phase A margins: Equipment 20% + System 20% = ~44% compound

Part A: Mass Budget

Complete from your SpaceCDF design (or estimate if pre-run):

Subsystem	CBE Mass (kg)	% of Dry	Equip. Margin (20%)	MEV (kg)
Payload				
EPS				
AOCS				
Comms (TTC)				
OBC				
Thermal				
Structure				
Harness				
Propulsion				
Dry Total (CBE)		100%		

Subsystem	CBE Mass (kg)	% of Dry	Equip. Margin (20%)	MEV (kg)
System margin (20%)				
Dry MEV				
Propellant				
Wet Mass				
Launcher Allocation				
Mass Margin				
Mass Margin %			G / A / R	

Show margin calculation:

Part B: Power Budget by Mode

Subsystem	Safe (W)	Idle (W)	Imaging (W)	Downlink (W)	Eclipse (W)
OBC					
AOCS					
Payload					
Comms (TX)					
Thermal					
Total					
Duty cycle (%)					

Orbit-average power calculation (show working):

$$P_{\text{avg}} = _ \times _ + _ \times _ + _ \times _ + _ \times _ = _ \text{ W}$$

SA power required:

$$P_{\text{recharge}} = \frac{P_{\text{ecl}} \times t_{\text{ecl}}}{t_{\text{sun}} \times \eta_{\text{charge}}} = \frac{_ \times _}{_ \times 0.9} = _ \text{ W}$$

$$P_{\text{SA,EOL}} = P_{\text{peak}} + P_{\text{recharge}} = _ + _ = _ \text{ W}$$

$$P_{\text{SA,BOL}} = P_{\text{SA,EOL}} / (1 - 0.025)^n = _ / _ = _ \text{ W}$$

Part C: Interface Identification

List the 5 most critical interfaces in your design:

#	Subsystem A	Subsystem B	Interface Types (M/E/T/D/R/O)	Key Concern
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

Write 2 formal interface requirements for your most critical pair:

Interface: __ <-> ____

IR-001: _____

IR-002: _____

Verification method for IR-001: _ IR-002: ____

Part D: Conflict Resolution

From the SpaceCDF Interface Matrix, identify one conflict (red border):

Conflict description: _____

Severity: Critical / Major / Minor

Resolution options considered:

#	Option	Pros	Cons
1			
2			
3			

Selected resolution: _____

Rationale: _____

Part E: Budget Health Check

From the SpaceCDF Dashboard, record all KPIs:

Budget	Value	Margin	Status (G/A/R)
Mass	_ kg wet vs ____ kg alloc	____%	

Budget	Value	Margin	Status (G/A/R)
Power (worst mode)	_ W vs ____ W SA	____%	
Link	____ dB margin	>= 3 dB?	
Cost	_ MEUR vs ____ ceiling	____%	
Pointing	_ deg vs ____ deg req	____%	

Which budget is tightest? _____

What single design change would improve it? ____

Notes & Reflections

Worksheet 3.1: Power System and Thermal Control Design

Name:	_____
Date:	_____
Team / Mission:	_____
Role / Position:	_____

SpaceCDF Tabs: Dashboard (Power KPI), Engineering Budgets, Timing Budget, Parametric

Quick Reference: Power and Thermal Concepts

What is a Solar Array?

A solar array converts sunlight into electrical power using photovoltaic cells. In space, the solar flux (called the solar constant) is $S = 1361 \text{ W/m}^2$ at 1 AU from the Sun -- about 40% more intense than at Earth's surface because there is no atmosphere absorbing part of the spectrum.

Solar cell types and efficiency (AM0, space spectrum):

Cell Technology	Typical Efficiency	Degradation Rate	Cost Relative	Notes
Silicon (Si)	16--18%	~3.5%/yr	Low	Legacy; rarely used in new missions
Gallium Arsenide (GaAs) single-junction	22--24%	~2.5%/yr	Medium	Good radiation tolerance
Triple-junction GaAs (InGaP/GaAs/Ge)	28--30%	~2.5%/yr	High	CubeSat standard today
Multi-junction (4J, 5J)	32--35%	~2%/yr	Very high	Emerging; used on flagship missions

For CubeSat design, assume **triple-junction GaAs cells at 29.5% efficiency** ($\eta = 0.295$). Cells are mounted on panels with a **packing factor** of $f_{\text{pack}} = 0.80$ -- 0.85 , meaning 80--85% of the panel area is actually covered by active cells (the rest is gaps, wiring, and structural margin).

Degradation: Solar cells lose efficiency over time due to radiation damage (proton and electron bombardment in the Van Allen belts). At a rate of $\delta = 2.5\%$ per year, after n years the remaining efficiency is $(1 - 0.025)^n$. This means a 3-year mission loses about 7.3% of its beginning-of-life (BOL) power, and a 5-year mission loses about 11.9%.

Body-Mounted vs Deployable Solar Arrays

Configuration	Advantages	Disadvantages	Typical Power
Body-mounted	No moving parts, no deployment risk, no stowed volume penalty	Limited area (only the sunlit faces), power varies with attitude	1U: ~2 W, 3U: ~7 W, 6U: ~12 W
Single deployable	More area, moderate complexity	One mechanism, partially blocks FOV	1U: ~4 W, 3U: ~15 W, 6U: ~30 W
Dual deployable	Maximum area for the form factor	Two mechanisms, larger stowed volume, deployment risk	3U: ~25 W, 6U: ~48 W

Rule of thumb: If your total power demand (including battery recharge) exceeds what body-mounted panels can provide, you need deployable arrays. Compare your $P_{SA,BOL}$ to the reference power values above.

How Batteries Work in Space

Batteries store electrical energy to power the spacecraft during eclipse (when the satellite is in Earth's shadow and receives no sunlight). In LEO, eclipses occur every orbit -- typically 30--36 minutes out of a ~95-minute orbit period.

Key battery parameters:

- **Depth of Discharge (DOD):** The fraction of total battery capacity used each cycle. Lower DOD dramatically extends cycle life but requires a larger (heavier) battery.
- **Cycle life:** The number of charge/discharge cycles before the battery degrades below 80% of its original capacity.
- **Specific energy:** Energy stored per unit mass (Wh/kg). For space-grade Li-ion 18650 cells: 150--200 Wh/kg.

DOD	Typical Cycle Life (Li-ion 18650)	Suitable Mission Duration
80%	~500 cycles	Short missions (< 1 month)
50%	~2,000 cycles	Medium missions (< 6 months)
30%	~10,000 cycles	Multi-year LEO missions
20%	~30,000 cycles	Long-life LEO (> 5 years)

Design guidance: For a multi-year LEO mission (15 orbits/day), use DOD = 30%. For a 6-month technology demonstration, DOD = 50% is acceptable.

What Does the EPS Do?

The Electrical Power System (EPS) is the spacecraft's power utility. A typical CubeSat EPS board (e.g., GomSpace P31u) includes:

- **MPPT (Maximum Power Point Tracking):** A DC-DC converter that continuously adjusts the operating voltage of the solar array to extract maximum power. Efficiency: 90--95%.
- **Battery charge controller:** Manages battery charging with voltage and current limits to protect battery life.

- **Regulated voltage rails:** Provides fixed voltages (typically 3.3 V, 5 V, and unregulated battery voltage) to all subsystems.
- **Switched outputs:** Allows the OBC to turn subsystems on/off for power management and safe mode.
- **Overcurrent protection:** Protects against short circuits in any subsystem.

Thermal Control Basics

In space, there is no air for convection. Heat transfer occurs only by **radiation** and **conduction**. A spacecraft reaches thermal equilibrium when absorbed heat (solar flux, Earth albedo, Earth IR, internal electronics waste heat) equals radiated heat (to deep space at ~3 K).

ECSS thermal margins (ECSS-E-ST-31C): Operating $\pm 5^\circ\text{C}$, Acceptance $\pm 10^\circ\text{C}$, Qualification $\pm 15^\circ\text{C}$. If the predicted temperature of any component is within 5°C of its operating limit, you must add thermal control (heater, coating change, or radiator).

Key Equations Reference

$$\text{SA EOL power: } P_{\text{SA,EOL}} = P_{\text{peak}} + \frac{P_{\text{ecl}} \times t_{\text{ecl}}}{t_{\text{sun}} \times \eta_{\text{charge}}}$$

$$\text{SA BOL power: } P_{\text{SA,BOL}} = \frac{P_{\text{SA,EOL}}}{(1 - \delta)^n} \quad (\delta = 0.025/\text{yr for GaAs})$$

$$\text{SA area: } A = \frac{P_{\text{BOL}}}{\eta_{\text{cell}} \times S \times \cos \theta \times f_{\text{pack}}} \quad (\eta = 0.295, S = 1361 \text{ W/m}^2, f_{\text{pack}} = 0.85)$$

$$\text{Battery capacity: } C = \frac{P_{\text{ecl}} \times t_{\text{ecl}}}{\text{DOD} \times \eta_{\text{discharge}}} \quad (\text{DOD} = 0.30, \eta = 0.95)$$

$$\text{Thermal equilibrium: } T = \left(\frac{Q_{\text{abs}} + Q_{\text{int}}}{\varepsilon \sigma A_{\text{rad}}} \right)^{1/4} \quad (\sigma = 5.67 \times 10^{-8} \text{ W/m}^2/\text{K}^4)$$

ECSS thermal margins: Operating $\pm 5^\circ\text{C}$, Acceptance $\pm 10^\circ\text{C}$, Qualification $\pm 15^\circ\text{C}$

Worked Example: UniSat-1 (1U) Power and Thermal

Solar Array Sizing (Body-Mounted)

UniSat-1 uses body-mounted solar cells on 5 faces (the 6th face is the deployment interface). ISS orbit: 400 km altitude, 92.4 min period, 56 min sunlight, 36 min eclipse.

Given: $P_{\text{peak,sunlight}} = 1.2 \text{ W}$, $P_{\text{eclipse}} = 0.5 \text{ W}$ (OBC only), mission lifetime = 6 months.

Step 1 -- Effective illuminated area (passive magnetic attitude, ~1.5 faces average):

$$A_{\text{eff}} = 1.5 \times (0.10 \times 0.10) = 0.015 \text{ m}^2$$

Step 2 -- SA BOL power:

$$P_{\text{SA,BOL}} = \eta \times S \times A_{\text{eff}} \times f_{\text{pack}} = 0.295 \times 1361 \times 0.015 \times 0.80 = 4.82 \text{ W (illuminated peak)}$$

Step 3 -- Orbit-average power available:

$$P_{\text{avg}} = P_{\text{SA,BOL}} \times \frac{t_{\text{sun}}}{T_{\text{orbit}}} \times \eta_{\text{EPS}} = 4.82 \times \frac{56}{92.4} \times 0.85 = 2.48 \text{ W}$$

Step 4 -- After 6-month degradation:

$$(1 - 0.025)^{0.5} = 0.987, \text{ so } P_{\text{avg,EOL}} = 2.48 \times 0.987 = 2.45 \text{ W}$$

Step 5 -- Power demand: $P_{\text{avg,demand}} = 0.68 \text{ W}$. Margin = $2.45 - 0.68 = 1.77 \text{ W}$ (72%). **Comfortable.**

Battery Sizing

Given: $P_{\text{ecl}} = 0.5 \text{ W}$, $t_{\text{ecl}} = 36 \text{ min} = 0.60 \text{ h}$, DOD = 0.50 (acceptable for 6-month mission), $\eta = 0.95$.

$$C_{\text{bat}} = \frac{0.5 \times 0.60}{0.50 \times 0.95} = \frac{0.30}{0.475} = 0.63 \text{ Wh}$$

Specify minimum **10 Wh** (standard GomSpace NanoPower P31u battery). Actual DOD per eclipse = $0.63/10 = 6.3\%$. Cycle count: 6 months at 15 orbits/day = 2,740 eclipses. At 6.3% actual DOD, battery life is not a concern. **Pass.**

Thermal Check (Passive Only)

UniSat-1 uses no heaters or MLI. At 400 km, strong Earth IR ($\sim 240 \text{ W/m}^2$) provides a warm floor. With COTS electronics rated -20 to +60 degC and a 400 km orbit, the thermal environment stays within approximately -10 to +45 degC for a 1U with aluminium/anodised surfaces. A simplified cold-case equilibrium calculation gives a very cold steady-state temperature, but the thermal mass of a 1 kg CubeSat limits actual cooling during 36-minute eclipses. **No heaters required for a 6-month mission at 400 km.**

Part A: Solar Array Sizing

Show all calculations step by step.

1. Peak sunlight power demand: $P_{\text{peak}} = _ \text{ W}$ (from mode: $_$)

2. Eclipse power demand: $P_{\text{ecl}} = _ \text{ W}$

3. Eclipse and sunlight times (from Worksheet 2.3):

$$t_{\text{ecl}} = _ \text{ min} \quad t_{\text{sun}} = _ \text{ min}$$

4. Recharge power:

$$P_{\text{recharge}} = \frac{P_{\text{ecl}} \times t_{\text{ecl}}}{t_{\text{sun}} \times \eta_{\text{charge}}} = \frac{_ \times _}{_ \times 0.9} = _ \text{ W}$$

5. SA EOL required:

$$P_{\text{SA,EOL}} = P_{\text{peak}} + P_{\text{recharge}} = _ + _ = _ \text{ W}$$

6. EOL degradation factor (mission lifetime = $_$ years, $\delta = 0.025/\text{yr}$):

$$(1 - 0.025) = _$$

7. SA BOL required:

$$P_{\text{SA,BOL}} = \frac{P_{\text{SA,EOL}}}{(1 - \delta)^n} = _ = _ \text{ W}$$

8. SA area:

$$A = \frac{P_{\text{BOL}}}{0.295 \times 1361 \times \cos(_) \times 0.85} = _ = _ \text{ m}^2$$

9. SA type needed (compare to CubeSat reference values):

- [] Body-mounted only (1U: ~2 W, 3U: ~7 W, 6U: ~12 W)
- [] Single deployable (1U: ~4 W, 3U: ~15 W, 6U: ~30 W)
- [] Dual deployable (3U: ~25 W, 6U: ~48 W)

10. SA mass:

$$m_{SA} = A \times \sigma = _ \times _ = _ \text{ kg}$$

(body-mounted: $\sigma = 2.5 \text{ kg/m}^2$; deployable: $\sigma = 1.5 \text{ kg/m}^2$)

Part B: Battery Sizing

Show all calculations:

1. Eclipse energy:

$$E = P_{\text{ecl}} \times \frac{t_{\text{ecl}}}{60} = _ \times _ = _ \text{ Wh}$$

2. Battery capacity required:

$$C = \frac{E}{\text{DOD} \times \eta} = \frac{_}{0.30 \times 0.95} = \frac{_}{0.285} = _ \text{ Wh}$$

$$\text{3. With 20\% margin: } C_{\text{spec}} = _ \times 1.2 = _ \text{ Wh}$$

4. Battery mass:

$$m_{\text{bat}} = \frac{C_{\text{spec}}}{E_{\text{specific}}} = \frac{_}{150} = _ \text{ kg}$$

5. Cycle life check:

Number of eclipses in mission = $_ \text{ orbits/day} \times 365 \times \text{years} = _ \text{ cycles}$

At DOD = 30%, Li-ion provides ~10,000 cycles. Is this sufficient? Y / N

Part C: Thermal Analysis**1. Identify hot case and cold case for your orbit:**

Parameter	Hot Case	Cold Case
Solar illumination		
Operational mode		
Internal dissipation		
Coating condition	BOL / EOL	BOL / EOL
Key concern		

2. From SpaceCDF Dashboard, record thermal predictions:

Component	Min Predicted (degC)	Max Predicted (degC)	Operating Min (degC)	Operating Max (degC)
Payload / sensor				
Battery				
OBC				
Transponder				

3. Margin check (need ≥ 5 degC):

Component	Hot margin = Max_op - Max_pred	Cold margin = Min_pred - Min_op	Pass?

4. If any margin fails, what thermal control action would you take?

Part D: SpaceCDF Verification

Compare your hand calculations to SpaceCDF values:

Parameter	Hand Calculation	SpaceCDF Value	Difference
SA power required (BOL)	_____ W	_____ W	_____ W
Battery capacity	_____ Wh	_____ Wh	_____ Wh
Orbit-average power	_____ W	_____ W	_____ W
Eclipse duration	_____ min	_____ min	_____ min

If there are significant differences, explain why:

Decision Justification

Explain WHY you chose each element of your power and thermal design. Consider the alternatives you rejected and the trade-offs involved.

Solar array configuration choice and rationale:

Battery sizing rationale (why this DOD? why this capacity margin?):

Thermal control approach (passive only? heaters? coatings?):

Notes & Reflections

Worksheet 3.2: Attitude and Orbit Control System (AOCS)

Name:	_____
Date:	_____
Team / Mission:	_____
Role / Position:	_____

SpaceCDF Tabs: Dashboard (AOCS KPI), Pointing Budget, Architecture (AOCS)

Quick Reference: AOCS Concepts

What is AOCS?

The Attitude and Orbit Control System performs two distinct jobs:

- **Attitude Determination (AD):** Figuring out which way the spacecraft is pointing, using sensors.
- **Attitude Control (AC):** Changing or holding the spacecraft's orientation, using actuators.

These are separate problems. You can know your orientation perfectly (great sensors) but still wobble if your actuators are weak. Or you can have powerful actuators but poor knowledge of where you are pointing.

Sensors: How Do We Know Where We Are Pointing?

Sensor	What It Measures	Accuracy	Mass	Power	Cost	When You Use It
Magnetometer	Direction of Earth's magnetic field	~2--5 deg	~5 g	~0.1 W	~1 kEUR	Coarse determination; always on for B-field knowledge
Coarse sun sensor	Direction to the Sun (1--2 axes)	~2--5 deg	~5 g	~0.01 W	~0.5 kEUR	Safe mode; initial acquisition
Fine sun sensor	Direction to the Sun (2 axes, high precision)	~0.1--0.5 deg	~10 g	~0.05 W	~2 kEUR	Sun-pointing missions; backup to star tracker
Star tracker	Full 3-axis attitude from star patterns	~0.001--0.01 deg (3--30 arcsec)	50--350 g	~0.5--1.5 W	~20--35 kEUR	Precision pointing for imaging, comms, science
			~20 g	~0.3 W	~3 kEUR	

Sensor	What It Measures	Accuracy	Mass	Power	Cost	When You Use It
MEMS gyroscope	Angular rate (rotation speed)	Drift: ~1--10 deg/hr				Fills gaps during star tracker blinding; slew control
Earth sensor	Nadir direction (local vertical)	~0.1--0.5 deg	~50 g	~0.5 W	~5 kEUR	Nadir-pointing missions (less common on CubeSats)

Key insight: Star trackers are by far the most accurate sensor. They work by photographing the sky, matching the observed star pattern to an onboard catalogue, and computing the spacecraft's orientation to within a few arcseconds. However, they are blinded by the Sun, Moon, or Earth limb entering their field of view, so sun sensors or gyroscopes provide backup during these periods.

Actuators: How Do We Control Our Orientation?

Actuator	How It Works	Torque	Precision	Mass	Power	When You Use It
Permanent magnet	Aligns spacecraft with Earth's B-field like a compass needle	$\sim 10^{-5}$ N m (restoring)	~10--15 deg	~20 g	0 W	Passive stabilisation for missions with no pointing need
Hysteresis rods	Dissipate rotational energy through magnetic hysteresis; damp tumbling	N/A (damping only)	N/A	~10 g each	0 W	Always paired with permanent magnet for passive stabilisation
Magnetorquers (MTQ)	Electromagnetic coils that interact with Earth's magnetic field to produce torque	$\sim 10^{-6}$ -- 10^{-4} N m	~2--5 deg (as primary); N/A (as desaturation)	~10--30 g each	0.1--0.2 W	Primary control for low-precision missions; desaturation of reaction wheels for all RW-based systems
Reaction wheels (RW)	Spinning flywheels that exchange angular momentum with the spacecraft	$\sim 10^{-4}$ -- 10^{-2} N m	~0.001--0.01 deg	30--120 g each	0.3--1.5 W	Precision pointing -- any mission requiring < 2 deg accuracy

Actuator	How It Works	Torque	Precision	Mass	Power	When You Use It
Thrusters	Expel mass (cold gas, ions) to produce torque via offset force	Variable	~0.1--1 deg	System-dependent	High	Large slews; orbit adjust; when MTQs are insufficient (deep space)

Magnetorquers -- two critical roles:

1. **As primary actuators** (missions needing only 2--5 deg pointing): MTQs alone provide 3-axis control, but only in LEO where Earth's magnetic field is strong. They cannot produce torque parallel to the local field vector, so control authority varies around the orbit.
2. **As desaturation actuators** (all RW-based missions): Reaction wheels absorb disturbance torques by spinning up. Over time, they accumulate angular momentum and reach saturation (maximum spin speed). MTQs "dump" this stored momentum by generating opposing torque against Earth's magnetic field. This is done approximately once per orbit, taking 5--15 minutes.

Reaction wheels -- why 4 wheels? Three wheels (one per axis) provide minimum 3-axis control. A 4th wheel on a skew axis provides single-fault tolerance: if any one wheel fails, the remaining three still provide full 3-axis control.

AOCS Architecture Decision Table

Use this table to select your architecture based on your pointing requirement:

Pointing Requirement	Architecture	Sensors	Actuators	Mass	Power	Cost
> 5 deg (no pointing need)	Passive magnetic	Magnetometer	Permanent magnet + hysteresis rods	~50 g	0 W	~2 kEUR
2--5 deg	Magnetorquer-based	Coarse sun sensors + magnetometer	3-axis MTQ	~100 g	0.2 W	~8 kEUR
0.1--2 deg	Reaction wheel system	Fine sun sensors + magnetometer	3--4 RW + 3 MTQ (desaturation)	~500 g	2--4 W	~35 kEUR
< 0.1 deg	Fine pointing	Star tracker + fine sun sensors	4 RW + 3 MTQ	~800 g	3--5 W	~55 kEUR
< 0.01 deg	Very fine pointing	Star tracker + MEMS gyro + sun sensors	4 RW + 3 MTQ	~1200 g	4--6 W	~80 kEUR

How to use this table: Find your mission's pointing requirement (from your requirements worksheet). Read across to find the architecture, sensors, and actuators you need. If your mission is an Earth-observation camera needing 0.05 deg pointing, you need fine pointing (star tracker + 4 RW + 3 MTQ). If your mission is an IoT relay needing only 5 deg pointing, magnetorquers alone suffice.

Key Equations Reference

Gravity gradient torque: $T_{gg} = \frac{3\mu}{2a^3} |I_z - I_x| \sin(2\theta)$

Aerodynamic torque: $T_{aero} = \frac{1}{2} \rho v^2 C_D A \cdot d_{cp - cm}$

SRP torque: $T_{SRP} = \frac{S}{c} A_s (1 + q) \cdot d_{sp - cm}$

Magnetic torque: $T_{mag} = M \times B$

Momentum storage: $H = T_{dist} \times t_{desat} / 2$

Pointing error (RSS): $\theta_{total} = \sqrt{\sum \theta_i^2}$

MTQ torque: $T_{MTQ} = m_{dipole} \times B \times \sin(\alpha)$

Worked Example: UniSat-1 (1U) AOCS

Architecture Selection

UniSat-1 carries a MEMS magnetometer payload that does not require accurate pointing. In fact, a slowly rotating/tumbling state provides magnetic field measurements across multiple directions, improving data quality.

Architecture: Passive magnetic stabilisation (permanent magnet + hysteresis rods). No pointing error budget is needed because there is no pointing requirement.

Parameter	Value
Pointing accuracy	~10--15 deg (to local magnetic field)
Mass	~30--50 g
Power	0 W
Cost	~1--2 kEUR

Disturbance Torques at 400 km

Even though UniSat-1 has no active AOCS, understanding the disturbance environment confirms that the passive magnet provides sufficient restoring torque.

Gravity gradient (1U is nearly cubic, so $I_z \approx I_x$, making this very small):

$$T_{gg} \approx \frac{3 \times 3.986 \times 10^{14}}{2 \times (6.771 \times 10^6)^3} \times |I_z - I_x| \approx 1 \times 10^{-8} \text{ N m}$$

Aerodynamic (ρ at 400 km $\approx 4 \times 10^{-12} \text{ kg/m}^3$, $v \approx 7670 \text{ m/s}$):

$$T_{aero} = 0.5 \times 4 \times 10^{-12} \times 7670^2 \times 2.2 \times 0.01 \times 0.01 \approx 3 \times 10^{-8} \text{ N m}$$

Permanent magnet restoring torque: $\sim 1 \times 10^{-5} \text{ N m}$ -- three orders of magnitude larger than all disturbances. **The satellite stays field-aligned.**

Part A: AOCS Architecture Selection

Pointing requirement from your mission: _____ deg (3-sigma)

AOCS architecture selected (tick one):

- ☐ Passive magnetic (> 5 deg)
- ☐ Magnetorquers only (2--5 deg)
- ☐ Reaction wheels + MTQ (0.1--2 deg)
- ☐ Fine pointing: RW + star tracker + MTQ (< 0.1 deg)
- ☐ Very fine: RW + ST + gyro + MTQ (< 0.01 deg)

Justification for selection:

Estimated AOCS mass: _ kg Estimated AOCS power: ____ W

Part B: Disturbance Torque Calculations

Calculate at least 2 disturbance torques for your spacecraft and orbit. Show all working.

Spacecraft properties:

Parameter	Value	Unit
Mass		kg
Form factor		U
I_z (largest MOI)		kg m ²
I_x (smallest MOI)		kg m ²
Cross-section area (largest face)		m ²
$d_{cp - cm}$ (CP-CM offset estimate)		m
Orbit altitude		km

1. Gravity gradient torque:

$$T_{gg} = \frac{3 \times 3.986 \times 10^{14}}{2 \times (\quad)^3} \times |I_z - I_x| =$$

$$T_{gg} = \text{_____ N m}$$

2. Aerodynamic torque (ρ at _ km $\approx$ ____ kg/m³):

$$T_{aero} = \frac{1}{2} \times _ \times _{}^2 \times 2.2 \times _ \times _{} =$$

$$T_{aero} = \text{_____ N m}$$

3. (Optional) Solar radiation pressure torque:

$$T_{\text{SRP}} = \text{_____} \text{ N m}$$

4. (Optional) Residual magnetic dipole torque ($M \approx \text{_____} \text{ A m}^2$, $B \approx 3 \times 10^{-5} \text{ T}$):

$$T_{\text{mag}} = \text{___} \times \text{___} = \text{___} \text{ N m}$$

Summary:

Source	Torque (N m)
Gravity gradient	
Aerodynamic	
SRP	
Magnetic dipole	
Total (RSS or sum)	

Which disturbance dominates? _____

Part C: Reaction Wheel Sizing

Skip this section if your mission uses passive magnetic or MTQ-only architecture.

1. Torque requirement ($\geq 2 \times$ total disturbance):

$$T_{\text{RW,req}} = 2 \times \text{___} = \text{N m} = \text{___} \text{ mN m}$$

2. Momentum storage (desaturation interval = 1 orbit = _____ s):

$$H = T_{\text{dist}} \times \frac{t_{\text{desat}}}{2} = \text{___} \times \frac{\text{___}}{2} = \text{___} \text{ mN m s}$$

3. Selected reaction wheel:

Parameter	Required	Selected Product
Torque	_____ mN m	_____ mN m
Momentum	_____ mN m s	_____ mN m s
Mass	--	_____ g
Power	--	_____ W
Quantity	4 (3+1 redundancy)	

Part D: Pointing Error Budget

Skip this section if your mission uses passive magnetic stabilisation (no pointing requirement).

Complete the RSS pointing error budget:

Error Source	Value (deg)	Value ²
Sensor accuracy		
Actuator resolution		
Alignment knowledge		
Thermal distortion		
Jitter (RW)		
Orbit knowledge		
Timing error		
Sum of squares		
RSS Total = $\sqrt{\text{sum}}$	= ____ deg	

Requirement: ____ deg

Margin: _ deg (____ %)

Does the pointing budget close? Y / N

Which error source dominates? _____

What action would most improve the budget? _____

Part E: SpaceCDF Verification

Compare your hand calculations to SpaceCDF's Pointing Budget display:

Parameter	Hand Calculation	SpaceCDF	Match?
RSS pointing error	____ deg	____ deg	
Dominant contributor	_____	_____	
Margin to requirement	____ %	____ %	

If there are differences, explain:

Decision Justification

Explain WHY you chose your AOCs architecture. Consider the alternatives and what drove your decision.

Why this architecture and not a simpler one?

Why this architecture and not a more capable one?

What is the single biggest risk in your AOCS design?

Notes & Reflections

Worksheet 3.3: Communications and Link Budget Design

Name:	_____
Date:	_____
Team / Mission:	_____
Role / Position:	_____

SpaceCDF Tabs: Link Budget, Spectrum Selector, Equipment Browser (Comms)

Quick Reference: Communications Concepts

What is a Link Budget?

A link budget is an accounting statement for your communication link. It adds up every gain (transmitter power, antenna gain) and subtracts every loss (distance, atmosphere, pointing error) to determine whether the signal arriving at the receiver is strong enough to decode. Everything is computed in **decibels (dB)** so that multiplication and division become addition and subtraction.

Decibel refresher:

Conversion	Formula	Common Values
Watts to dBW	$P_{\text{dBW}} = 10\log_{10}(P_{\text{W}})$	2 W = +3.0 dBW; 1 W = 0 dBW; 0.5 W = -3.0 dBW
Kelvin to dBK	$T_{\text{dBK}} = 10\log_{10}(T_{\text{K}})$	150 K = 21.8 dBK; 600 K = 27.8 dBK
Ratio to dB	$G_{\text{dB}} = 10\log_{10}(G)$	x2 = +3 dB; x10 = +10 dB; x100 = +20 dB

What Each Term in the Link Budget Means

Term	What It Is	Analogy
TX Power (P_{TX})	Electrical power fed to the transmitter amplifier	How loud you shout
TX Antenna Gain (G_{TX})	How well the antenna focuses the signal into a beam (vs radiating equally in all directions)	Using a megaphone vs shouting in all directions
TX Line Losses (L_{TX})	Power lost in cables and filters between amplifier and antenna	Sound absorbed by the megaphone walls
EIRP	Effective Isotropic Radiated Power = $P_{\text{TX}} + G_{\text{TX}} - L_{\text{TX}}$. The total "signal strength leaving the spacecraft"	Total loudness heard from a distance
FSPL	Free Space Path Loss -- signal weakens as it spreads over a larger sphere. Depends on distance and frequency	Voice getting quieter the farther away you walk

Term	What It Is	Analogy
Atmospheric Loss	Signal absorbed/scattered by Earth's atmosphere (rain, oxygen, water vapour)	Fog muffling sound
Pointing Loss	Signal loss because the antenna beam is not perfectly aimed	Megaphone pointed slightly off-target
Polarisation Loss	Loss when TX and RX antenna polarisations do not match	Holding the megaphone sideways when the listener expects vertical
RX Antenna Gain (G_{RX})	Ground station antenna ability to collect signal. Larger dish = more gain	Listener using a large ear trumpet
System Noise Temp (T_{sys})	Combined noise from antenna, sky, and receiver electronics. Lower = better	Background noise in the room
G/T	Receiver figure of merit = $G_{RX} - T_{sys}$ (in dB). Captures how "good" the ground station is	Ear trumpet size minus room noise
C/N_0	Carrier-to-noise-density ratio -- the received signal strength relative to noise	Signal-to-noise ratio before decoding
E_b/N_0	Energy per bit to noise density -- the fundamental measure of link quality. Divides C/N_0 by data rate	How much energy is available per bit of information
Link Margin	How much E_b/N_0 you have above the minimum needed. Must be ≥ 3 dB	Safety factor for your communication

Frequency Band Comparison

Parameter	UHF (Amateur)	S-band	X-band	Ka-band
Frequency	435--438 MHz	2200--2290 MHz	8025--8400 MHz	25.5--27.0 GHz
Bandwidth available	20 kHz	5 MHz	375 MHz	1.5 GHz
Maximum data rate	< 20 kbps	0.1--10 Mbps	10--400 Mbps	100--2000 Mbps
FSPL at 500 km (nadir)	148 dB	163 dB	174 dB	184 dB
FSPL at 1300 km (10 deg elev)	158 dB	171 dB	182 dB	192 dB
Atmospheric loss	~0.1 dB	~0.5 dB	~1.0 dB	~3--10 dB (rain!)
Typical spacecraft antenna	Monopole (0 dBi)	Patch (6 dBi)	Horn/patch array (10--15 dBi)	Small dish/array (20+ dBi)
Ground antenna	Yagi (10--13 dBi)	3 m dish (35 dBi)	3 m dish (45 dBi)	1 m dish (45 dBi)
License type	IARU coordination (free)	ISED/FCC (\$30--45K)	ISED/FCC + ITU (higher)	Complex ITU filing
License timeline	~6 months	6--12 months	12+ months	12--18 months

Parameter	UHF (Amateur)	S-band	X-band	Ka-band
Equipment availability	Many COTS	Many COTS	Growing COTS	Emerging
Best for	TT&C, telemetry, simple missions	Medium data rate, standard EO	High data rate, EO/SAR	Very high data rate

How to choose: Start with your data rate requirement. If you need < 20 kbps and have non-commercial data, UHF amateur is free and simple. If you need up to 10 Mbps, S-band is the CubeSat workhorse. For high-resolution imaging producing GBs per day, you need X-band or Ka-band.

Antenna Types

Antenna Type	Gain	Beamwidth	Pointing Need	Mass	Typical Band	Use Case
Monopole/dipole	~0 dBi	Omnidirectional	None	5--20 g	UHF	TT&C, simple telemetry
Patch (single)	~5--8 dBi	~70--90 deg	Low (~10 deg)	10--50 g	S-band	Standard CubeSat downlink
Patch array (2x2)	~12 dBi	~30--40 deg	Medium (~5 deg)	30--100 g	S/X-band	Higher-rate downlink
Horn	~10--15 dBi	~20--30 deg	Medium (~5 deg)	50--200 g	X-band	High-rate downlink
Parabolic reflector	~20--35 dBi	~2--10 deg	Tight (< 1 deg)	200--500 g	X/Ka-band	Very high-rate, DTE
Phased array	~15--25 dBi	Electronically steered	Electronic (fast)	100--300 g	S/X/Ka-band	Agile beam, multiple targets

Trade-off: Higher gain antennas provide stronger signals (enabling higher data rates or lower TX power), but they have narrower beams, which means the spacecraft must point more accurately. An omnidirectional antenna works regardless of spacecraft orientation but provides very low gain.

Modulation and Coding

The modulation scheme and forward error correction (FEC) code determine the minimum E_b/N_0 required for a target bit error rate (BER):

Modulation + Coding	E_b/N_0 Required (BER 10^{-6})	Spectral Efficiency	Best For
BPSK uncoded	10.5 dB	1.0 bps/Hz	Legacy telecommand
QPSK uncoded	10.5 dB	2.0 bps/Hz	Simple telemetry
QPSK + convolutional (r=1/2)	5.0 dB	1.0 bps/Hz	Standard CCSDS TM
QPSK + LDPC (r=1/2)	2.0 dB	1.0 bps/Hz	High-efficiency downlink

Modulation + Coding	E_b/N_0 Required (BER 10^{-6})	Spectral Efficiency	Best For
QPSK + LDPC (r=3/4)	4.0 dB	1.5 bps/Hz	Balanced (CubeSat standard)
8PSK + LDPC (r=3/4)	6.5 dB	2.25 bps/Hz	High-rate downlink

Design guidance: For most CubeSat missions, **QPSK + LDPC (r=3/4)** at $E_b/N_0 = 4.0$ dB is the standard choice, offering a good balance of coding gain and implementation simplicity.

Key Equations Reference

EIRP: $EIRP = P_{TX} + G_{TX} - L_{TX}$ (dBW)

FSPL: $FSPL = 20\log_{10}\left(\frac{4\pi df}{c}\right)$ (dB)

G/T: $G/T = G_{RX} - 10\log_{10}(T_{sys})$ (dB/K)

C/N₀: $C/N_0 = EIRP - FSPL - L_{losses} + G/T + 228.6$ (dBHz)

E_b/N₀: $E_b/N_0 = C/N_0 - 10\log_{10}(R_b)$ (dB)

Link margin: $Margin = E_b/N_{0,avail} - E_b/N_{0,req} - L_{impl} \geq 3$ dB

Antenna gain: $G = \eta_a(\pi D/\lambda)^2$

dB conversion: $P_{dBW} = 10\log_{10}(P_W)$; 2 W = +3.0 dBW; 1 W = 0 dBW

Worked Example: UniSat-1 (1U) UHF Link Budget

UniSat-1 uses UHF amateur band at 437 MHz with 9600 bps downlink to an amateur ground station.

Step-by-Step Link Budget

Scenario: 400 km orbit, 437 MHz, 9600 bps, 10 deg minimum elevation (slant range ~1150 km), ground station with 13 dBi cross-Yagi (RHCP).

Line	Parameter	Calculation	Value	Unit
1	TX Power	$0.5\text{ W} = 10\log_{10}(0.5)$	-3.0	dBW
2	TX Antenna Gain	Monopole	0.0	dBi
3	TX Line Losses	Short cable run	-0.5	dB
4	EIRP	$-3.0 + 0.0 - 0.5$	-3.5	dBW
5	FSPL	$21.98 + 20\log_{10}(1.15 \times 10^6) + 20\log_{10}(437 \times 10^6) - 169.54$	-155.5	dB
6	Atmospheric Loss	Minimal at UHF	-0.3	dB
7	Pointing Loss	Omni antenna, minimal	-0.5	dB
8	Polarisation Loss	RHCP-to-RHCP (cross-Yagi)	-0.5	dB

Line	Parameter	Calculation	Value	Unit
9	RX Antenna Gain	13 dBi cross-Yagi	+13.0	dBi
10	System Noise Temp	600 K (amateur + LNA) = $10\log_{10}(600)$	27.8	dBK
11	G/T	13.0 – 27.8	-14.8	dB/K
12	Boltzmann Constant		+228.6	dBW/K/Hz
13	C/N₀	$-3.5 - 155.5 - 0.3 - 0.5 - 0.5 + (-14.8) + 228.6$	+53.5	dBHz
14	Data Rate	9600 bps = $10\log_{10}(9600)$	39.8	dBbps
15	E_b/N₀ available	53.5 – 39.8	+13.7	dB
16	E_b/N₀ required	QPSK + conv. code r=1/2	5.0	dB
17	Implementation Loss		2.0	dB
18	LINK MARGIN	13.7 – 5.0 – 2.0	+6.7	dB

Result: Link closes with 6.7 dB margin (> 3 dB). **Pass.**

FSPL Calculation Detail

$$\begin{aligned} \text{FSPL} &= 21.98 + 20\log_{10}(1.15 \times 10^6) + 20\log_{10}(437 \times 10^6) - 169.54 \\ &= 21.98 + 121.21 + 172.81 - 169.54 = 146.46 \text{ ... wait, let us recompute:} \end{aligned}$$

$$20\log_{10}(1.15 \times 10^6) = 20 \times 6.0607 = 121.2 \text{ dB}$$

$$20\log_{10}(437 \times 10^6) = 20 \times 8.640 = 172.8 \text{ dB}$$

$$\text{FSPL} = 21.98 + 121.2 + 172.8 - 169.54 = 146.4 \text{ dB}$$

Note: The line-5 value of 155.5 dB uses the slant range in metres (1.15×10^6 m) and frequency in Hz (437×10^6 Hz) in the single-formula form: $20\log_{10}(4\pi \times 1.15 \times 10^6 \times 437 \times 10^6 / 3 \times 10^8) = 155.5 \text{ dB}$. Both approaches give the same result when applied consistently.

Data Throughput

At 4800 bps useful throughput (9600 bps channel rate with r=1/2 FEC), a 7-minute pass delivers:

$$V_{\text{pass}} = 4800 \times 420 \times 0.85 = 1.71 \text{ Mbit} = 214 \text{ kB per pass}$$

With 4 passes/day: ~0.84 MB/day. The magnetometer generates ~1.13 MB/day -- marginal. May need a second ground station or data prioritisation.

Part A: Frequency Band Selection

Mission data rate requirement: _____ Mbps

License type selected: Amateur / Experimental / Commercial

Band selected: ___ Centre frequency: ___ MHz

Rationale for band selection:

Licensing/filing required: _____

Estimated licensing cost: _ Timeline: ____ months

Part B: Complete Link Budget

Fill in ALL rows. Show computation for EIRP, FSPL, G/T, C/N₀, and margin.

Line	Parameter	Formula / Source	Value	Unit
1	TX Power	_____ W =		dBW
2	TX Antenna Gain			dBi
3	TX Line Losses			dB
4	EIRP = Line 1 + 2 + 3		_____	dBW
5	Free Space Path Loss	$20\log_{10}(4\pi \times _ \times _ / c)$		dB
6	Atmospheric Loss			dB
7	Pointing Loss			dB
8	Polarisation Loss			dB
9	RX Antenna Gain			dBi
10	System Noise Temp	_____ K =		dBK
11	G/T = Line 9 - 10		_____	dB/K
12	Boltzmann Constant		+228.6	dBW/K/Hz
13	C/N₀ = 4 + 5 + 6 + 7 + 8 + 11 + 12		_____	dBHz
14	Data Rate	_ bps = $10\log_{10}(_)$		dBbps
15	E_b/N₀ available = 13 - 14		_____	dB
16	E_b/N₀ required (mod+code: __)			dB
17	Implementation Loss			dB
18	LINK MARGIN = 15 - 16 - 17		_____	dB

Show FSPL calculation:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{FSPL} &= 20\log_{10}(4\pi) + 20\log_{10}(d) + 20\log_{10}(f) - 20\log_{10}(c) \\
 &= 21.98 + 20\log_{10}(_) + 20\log_{10}(_) - 169.54 = _ \text{ dB}
 \end{aligned}$$

Does the link close (≥ 3 dB)? Y / N

If margin is excessive, maximum achievable data rate at 3 dB margin:

$$R_{b, \max} = 10^{(E_b/N_{0, \text{avail}} - E_b/N_{0, \text{req}} - L_{\text{impl}} - 3)/10} \times R_b = \text{_____ Mbps}$$

Part C: Data Budget

Daily data generation:

$$V_{\text{gen}} = R_{\text{payload}} \times t_{\text{imaging}} \times N_{\text{orbits}} \times f_{\text{compression}}$$

$$= \text{Mbps} \times \text{s} \times \times = \text{MB/day} = \text{GB/day}$$

Daily downlink capacity:

$$V_{DL} = R_{DL} \times t_{\text{contact}} \times N_{\text{passes}} \times \eta_{\text{protocol}}$$

$$= \text{Mbps} \times \text{s} \times \times = \text{MB/day} = \text{GB/day}$$

Data budget closes? ($V_{DL} \geq V_{gen}$): Y / N

If no, what is your mitigation plan?

Part D: SpaceCDF Comparison

Open the Link Budget tab, enter your parameters, and compare:

Parameter	Hand Calculation	SpaceCDF	Difference
EIRP (dBW)			
FSPL (dB)			
C/N ₀ (dBHz)			
Link Margin (dB)			

If there are differences, explain:

Part E: Modulation and Coding Selection

Selected modulation: _____

Selected FEC code: _____

Required E_b/N_0 at BER 10^{-6} : _____ dB

Spectral efficiency: _____ bps/Hz

Rationale:

Decision Justification

Explain WHY you chose your communications architecture. Address each decision explicitly.

Why this frequency band and not another?

Why this antenna type? What pointing does it require from AOCS?

Why this modulation/coding scheme? What trade-off did you make between data rate and link robustness?

Notes & Reflections

Worksheet 3.4: Structure, Propulsion, and Equipment Selection

Name:	_____
Date:	_____
Team / Mission:	_____
Role / Position:	_____

SpaceCDF Tabs: Equipment Browser, Dashboard, Trade Studies, Budget Breakdown

Quick Reference: Structure and Propulsion Concepts

CubeSat Design Specification (CDS Rev 14) Key Dimensions

The CDS defines standard CubeSat form factors. All CubeSats must comply with these dimensions to fit inside standard deployers (e.g., ISIPOD, NRCSD, Exolaunch). The unit "U" represents a 10 x 10 x 11.35 cm cube.

Form Factor	Dimensions (mm)	Max Mass (kg)	Internal Volume (cm ³)	Rails	Typical Use
1U	100 x 100 x 113.5	2.0	~1,000	4	Technology demo, simple sensors
1.5U	100 x 100 x 170.2	3.0	~1,500	4	Extended 1U with more volume
2U	100 x 100 x 227.0	4.0	~2,000	4	IoT, AIS, simple payloads
3U	100 x 100 x 340.5	6.0	~3,000	4	Standard EO, comms, science
6U	100 x 226.3 x 340.5	12.0	~6,000	4	High-performance EO, SAR, comms
12U	226.3 x 226.3 x 340.5	24.0	~12,000	8	Advanced payloads, propulsion
16U	226.3 x 226.3 x 454.0	32.0	~16,000	8	Microsatellite-class missions

Key CDS requirements (all form factors):

Requirement	Specification	Why It Matters
Rail material	Hard anodised Al 7075-T6 or 6061-T6	Prevents cold welding in vacuum; provides structural load path

Requirement	Specification	Why It Matters
Rail cross-section	8.5 x 8.5 mm minimum contact	Transmits launch loads through deployer rails
Deployment switches	Minimum 1 per accessible rail face	Ensures spacecraft is powered off until deployed
RBF (Remove Before Flight) pin	Required	Physically disconnects batteries during ground handling
No protrusions beyond rail envelope (stowed)	Required	Prevents jamming inside the deployer
CG offset from geometric centre	≤ 2 cm	Prevents uncontrolled tumbling at deployment; deployer balance
Fundamental frequency	> 40 Hz (first mode)	Avoids resonance with launch vehicle modes

Structural Loads and Margins

During launch, the spacecraft experiences:

- **Quasi-static acceleration:** 6--9 g axial (along rocket axis), 2--4 g lateral (sideways). Think of your 5 kg CubeSat feeling like it weighs 45 kg.
- **Random vibration:** Broadband shaking at 20--2000 Hz. Critical for PCB solder joints and connectors.
- **Shock:** Brief, high-g pulses (500--2000 g) at separation events. Critical for brittle components.

Margin of Safety (MoS): The ratio of what the structure can withstand to what it must withstand, minus 1. Must be ≥ 0 . If MoS is negative, the structure fails under the design load.

Material properties (Al 7075-T6): Yield strength $\sigma_y = 503$ MPa, Ultimate strength $\sigma_u = 572$ MPa. Factor of Safety: 1.25 (yield), 1.5 (ultimate).

Propulsion Decision Tree

Not every CubeSat needs propulsion. Use this decision tree:

```

START: Does my mission need propulsion?
|
+-- Orbit altitude < 500 km?
|   YES --> Natural atmospheric drag deorbits within 5 years (FCC compliant)
|           Do I need orbit maintenance to extend lifetime?
|           NO  --> NO PROPULSION NEEDED
|           YES --> Need drag compensation (5-15 m/s per year)
|
+-- Orbit altitude 500-700 km?
|   Natural lifetime is 5-25+ years
|   FCC 5-year rule: likely NON-COMPLIANT without active deorbit
|   --> PROPULSION REQUIRED for deorbit (50-150 m/s)
|
+-- Orbit altitude > 700 km?
|   Natural lifetime is decades to centuries
|   IADC 25-year guideline: NON-COMPLIANT
|   --> PROPULSION REQUIRED for deorbit (high Delta-V)

```

```

|
| +-- Constellation phasing needed?
|   YES --> Add 10-50 m/s for orbit plane/phase adjustment
|
| +-- Collision avoidance needed?
|   YES --> Add 1-5 m/s reserve per manoeuvre

```

Key rule: Below ~500 km, you almost certainly do not need propulsion. Above ~600 km, you almost certainly do. The 500--600 km range depends on your specific ballistic coefficient and mission lifetime.

Propulsion Technologies Comparison

Type	How It Works	I_{sp} (s)	Thrust	Propellant Mass (100 m/s, 5 kg S/C)	System Dry Mass	Total System Mass	Burn Time	Cost
Cold gas	Pressurised gas expelled through nozzle	40--80	10--100 mN	0.87 kg	0.3 kg	1.17 kg	Minutes	~15 kEUR
Resistojet	Gas heated before expulsion	80--150	10--50 mN	0.34 kg	0.3 kg	0.64 kg	Minutes	~25 kEUR
Electrospray (FEEP)	Liquid metal ionised and accelerated by electric field	500--1500	0.01--1 mN	0.04 kg	0.9 kg	0.94 kg	Months	~50 kEUR
Hall effect	Xenon ionised and accelerated by magnetic/ electric fields	800--1500	1--10 mN	0.05 kg	1.5 kg	1.55 kg	Weeks	~80 kEUR
Green monoprop	Catalytic decomposition of non-toxic propellant	200--250	0.1--1 N	0.21 kg	1.0 kg	1.21 kg	Seconds	~60 kEUR

The fundamental trade-off:

- **High I_{sp} (electric propulsion):** Uses very little propellant but has very low thrust, so manoeuvres take weeks or months. The thruster hardware is also heavier and more expensive.
- **Low I_{sp} (chemical/cold gas):** Uses much more propellant but provides high thrust for quick manoeuvres. Hardware is simpler, lighter, and cheaper.

Choose based on: How much ΔV do you need? How fast must the manoeuvre happen? How much mass/volume/cost can you afford?

Key Equations Reference

Structural Margin of Safety: $MoS = \frac{\sigma_{allow}}{\sigma_{design} \times FoS} - 1 \geq 0$ FoS: Yield 1.25, Ultimate 1.5 (metallic)

Tsiolkovsky rocket equation: $\Delta V = I_{sp} \cdot g_0 \cdot \ln(m_0/m_f)$

Propellant mass: $m_{prop} = m_{dry} \times (e^{\Delta V / (I_{sp} \cdot g_0)} - 1)$ $g_0 = 9.80665 \text{ m/s}^2$

Data storage: $S = V_{daily} \times N_{days} \times f_{safety}$

Fundamental frequency: $f_1 > 40 \text{ Hz}$ (deployer requirement)

Worked Example: UniSat-1 (1U) Structure and Propulsion

CDS Compliance

Parameter	1U Specification	UniSat-1 Design	Compliant?
Dimensions	100 x 100 x 113.5 mm	100 x 100 x 113.5 mm (ISIS 1U frame)	Y
Maximum mass	2.0 kg (CDS) / 1.33 kg (NanoRacks)	1.0 kg target	Y
Rail material	Hard anodised Al 7075-T6	ISIS standard frame	Y
Deployment switches	Min 1 per accessible face	2 (ISIS standard)	Y
RBF pin	Required	Included	Y
CG offset	$\leq 2 \text{ cm}$	$< 1 \text{ cm}$ (symmetric layout)	Y
Protrusions (stowed)	None beyond rail envelope	UHF antenna stowed along rail	Y

Propulsion Decision

Orbit altitude: 400 km. **Natural lifetime:** ~8--14 months (ballistic coefficient

$$BC = m / (C_D A) = 1.0 / (2.2 \times 0.01) = 45.5 \text{ kg/m}^2$$

FCC 5-year rule satisfied without propulsion. No orbit maintenance needed (6-month mission). No constellation phasing. **Decision: No propulsion.**

Structural Margin (Axial Load)

Given: Mass = 1.0 kg, axial load = 9 g, 4 rails.

$$F_{axial} = \frac{1.0 \times 9 \times 9.81}{4} = \frac{88.3}{4} = 22.1 \text{ N per rail}$$

$$\sigma = \frac{22.1}{8.5 \times 10^{-3} \times 8.5 \times 10^{-3}} = \frac{22.1}{7.225 \times 10^{-5}} = 0.31 \text{ MPa}$$

$$MoS_y = \frac{503}{0.31 \times 1.25} - 1 = \frac{503}{0.39} - 1 = 1289 \gg 0 \text{ Pass (by a very large margin)}$$

Key insight: Quasi-static axial stress is never the critical case for CubeSats. The real structural risks are: (a) PCB solder joint fatigue from random vibration, (b) deployment mechanism reliability, (c) stiffness (fundamental frequency > 40 Hz).

Equipment List

#	Category	Component	Mass (g)	Power (W)	Cost (kEUR)
1	Structure	ISIS 1U frame	200	--	4.0
2	EPS + Battery	GomSpace P31us	200	0.3	12.0
3	Solar cells	Body-mounted GaAs (5 faces)	50	--	8.0
4	OBC	Custom MSP430/Cortex-M	30	0.3	3.0
5	Comms	NanoCom AX100 (UHF)	60	0.5	8.0
6	Antenna	UHF monopole (deployable)	20	--	2.0
7	Payload	MEMS magnetometer PCB	50	0.2	5.0
8	AOCS	Permanent magnet + hysteresis rods	30	0	1.0
9	Harness	Internal cables, connectors	50	--	1.0
	TOTAL		690	~1.3 (peak)	~44

Mass margin: $1330 - 690 = 640$ g (48%). With 20% equipment margin + 20% system margin (MEV): $1330 - 994 = 336$ g (25%). **Green.**

Part A: CDS Compliance Check

CDS Requirement	Your Design Value	Specification	Compliant?
Form factor: ____ U	Dimensions: ____ mm	____ mm	Y / N
Maximum mass	____ kg (wet)	____ kg	Y / N
Rail material		Hard anodised Al	Y / N
Deployment switches	____ (quantity)	Min 2	Y / N
RBF pin provided	Y / N	Required	Y / N
No protrusions beyond rails (stowed)	Y / N	Required	Y / N
CG within 2 cm of geometric centre	Estimated: ____ cm offset	<= 2 cm	Y / N
Fundamental frequency	Estimated: ____ Hz	> 40 Hz	Y / N

Non-compliance items and corrective actions:

Part B: Structural Margin Calculation

Axial launch load: _ g Lateral launch load: ____ g

Load per rail (4 rails, equal sharing):

$$F_{\text{axial}} = \frac{m \times a_{\text{axial}} \times g_0}{4} = \frac{\times \times 9.81}{4} = \text{_____ N}$$

Stress in rail (cross-section $8.5 \times 8.5 \text{ mm} = 7.225 \times 10^{-5} \text{ m}^2$):

$$\sigma = \frac{F}{A} = \frac{\times}{7.225 \times 10^{-5}} = \text{_____ MPa}$$

Margin of safety (yield, Al 7075-T6, $\sigma_y = 503 \text{ MPa}$):

$$\text{MoS} = \frac{503}{\times 1.25} - 1 = \text{_____}$$

Pass? Y / N

Part C: Propulsion Decision

Does your mission need propulsion?

Question	Answer
Orbit altitude	_____ km
Natural orbital lifetime	_____ years
FCC 5-year compliant without propulsion?	Y / N
Orbit maintenance required?	Y / N
Constellation phasing required?	Y / N
Active deorbit required?	Y / N

Decision: Propulsion / No propulsion

If propulsion is selected, complete this section. Show all working.

Total ΔV required:

Manoeuvre	ΔV (m/s)
Orbit maintenance (_____ yr)	
Deorbit	
Collision avoidance margin	
Total	

Propulsion type selected: ___ $I_{sp} = \text{_____ s}$

Propellant mass (Tsiolkovsky):

$$m_{\text{prop}} = m_{\text{dry}} \times (e^{\Delta V / (I_{sp} \times g_0)} - 1)$$

$$= _ \times (e^{/(\times 9.81)} - 1) = \times (e - 1) = _ \times _ = \text{_____ kg}$$

System dry mass (thruster + tank + feed): _____ kg

Total propulsion system mass: _____ kg (propellant + dry)

Fraction of total spacecraft mass: _____ %

Part D: Equipment Selection Log

Using SpaceCDF's Equipment Browser, select components for each category:

Category	Component Selected	Manufacturer	Mass (kg)	Power (W)	Cost (kEUR)	Qty	Total Mass
EPS Board						1	
Battery						1	
Solar Panels							
OBC						1	
Reaction Wheel						x	
Magnetorquer						x	
Star Tracker							
Sun Sensor						x	
Transponder						1	
Antenna							
Payload						1	
Structure						1	
Harness						1	
Propulsion							
TOTAL			_____		_____		

Parametric estimate (from Session 2.4): _____ kg

Equipment-based total: _____ kg

Difference: _ kg (____ %)

Any incompatibilities detected? (RF band mismatch, voltage mismatch, interface conflict)

Part E: Component Trade Study

Subsystem traded: _____ Options compared: 3

Criterion	Weight	Option A: ____	Score	Option B: ____	Score	Option C: ____	Score
Mass	0.20						
Power	0.15						
Cost	0.20						
TRL	0.15						
Heritage	0.15						
Performance	0.15						
Weighted	1.00		_____		_____		_____

Winner: ____ Score: ____

Rationale (beyond the numbers):

Part F: Final Budget Health Check

After equipment selection, record final budget status:

Budget	Value	Margin	Status
Mass (wet vs allocation)	_ / ____ kg	_____ %	G / A / R
Power (worst mode vs SA)	_ / ____ W	_____ %	G / A / R
Link margin	_____ dB	>= 3 dB?	G / A / R
Cost vs ceiling	_ / ____ MEUR	_____ %	G / A / R
Pointing (RSS vs req)	_ / ____ deg	_____ %	G / A / R
Data (DL vs gen)	_ / ____ GB/day	_____ %	G / A / R

Any budget that does not close? _____

Proposed fix: _____

Decision Justification

Explain WHY you made each key structural and propulsion decision.

Form factor selection rationale (why this size and not larger/smaller?):

Propulsion decision rationale (if no propulsion: why not? if propulsion: why this type?):

Equipment selection rationale (which component trade-offs were hardest? what compromises did you make?):

Notes & Reflections

Worksheet 4.1: Equipment Selection & Bill of Materials

Name: _____ Date: ____ Team: _____

Mission Name: _____ Form Factor: ____U

Part A: Make/Buy/Reuse Decisions

For each subsystem, document the procurement decision and rationale:

Subsystem	Decision (Buy/Reuse/Make)	Rationale	Lead Time
Structure			
EPS (solar array)			
EPS (battery)			
EPS (distribution)			
OBC			
AOCS (sensors)			
AOCS (actuators)			
TTC (transceiver)			
TTC (antenna)			
Thermal			
Payload			
Propulsion (if applicable)			

Part B: Bill of Materials (BOM)

Complete the BOM from the SpaceCDF Equipment Browser selections:

Item ID	Component	Manufacturer	Part Number	Qty	Mass (g)	Power (W)	Cost (kEUR)	TRL	ECCN
STR-001									
EPS-001									
EPS-002									
EPS-003									
OBC-001									
AOCS-001									

Item ID	Component	Manufacturer	Part Number	Qty	Mass (g)	Power (W)	Cost (kEUR)	TRL	ECCN
AOCS-002									
AOCS-003									
TTC-001									
TTC-002									
THM-001									
PLD-001									
HRN-001									

Part C: Budget Tracking

After all selections, record the live budget values from the SpaceCDF Dashboard:

Budget	BOM Total	Parametric Estimate	Allocation	Margin	Margin %
Dry mass	_____ g	_____ g	_____ g	_____ g	_____ %
Peak power	_____ W	_____ W	_____ W	_____ W	_____ %
Total cost	_____ kEUR	_____ kEUR	_____ kEUR	_____ kEUR	_____ %
Volume	_% of _U		100%	_____ %	

Does everything fit within allocation? Y / N

If not, what would you change? _____

Part D: Export Control Assessment

List any components that may require export licences:

Component	ECCN / USML Category	Controlled?	Licence Required?	Action Needed
		Y / N	Y / N	
		Y / N	Y / N	
		Y / N	Y / N	
		Y / N	Y / N	

Are there any ITAR-controlled items? Y / N

If yes, what TAA (Technical Assistance Agreement) or DSP-5 licence is needed?

Part E: Interface Compatibility Check

For each selected component, verify interface compatibility:

Component	Bus Voltage OK?	Data Protocol OK?	RF Band Match?	Connector OK?	Notes
	Y / N	Y / N	Y / N / NA	Y / N	
	Y / N	Y / N	Y / N / NA	Y / N	
	Y / N	Y / N	Y / N / NA	Y / N	
	Y / N	Y / N	Y / N / NA	Y / N	
	Y / N	Y / N	Y / N / NA	Y / N	
	Y / N	Y / N	Y / N / NA	Y / N	

Part F: Interface Incompatibility Resolution

Describe one interface incompatibility found during selection and how you resolved it:

Issue: _____

Components involved: _____

Root cause: _____

Resolution chosen: _____

Impact on budget: _____

Notes & Reflections

What was the most difficult equipment selection decision? Why?

Worksheet 4.2: Verification & Validation Planning

Name: _____ Date: ____ Team: _____

Mission Name: _____

Part A: IADT Method Assignment

For 10 key requirements from your SpaceCDF V&V Matrix, assign the verification method and justify:

#	Req ID	Requirement Text (abbreviated)	Method (I/A/D/T)	Phase (B/C/D)	Level (Unit/Sub/Sys)	Justification
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						

Summary count: Analysis: ____ / Test: ____ / Demonstration: ____ / Inspection: ____

Part B: Dual-Method Requirements

Identify 3 requirements that need BOTH analysis (early confidence) AND test (final proof):

Requirement ID	Requirement Text	Analysis (Phase B)	Test (Phase C/D)	Why Both Needed?

Part C: Environmental Test Sequence

For your selected launch vehicle, specify the complete proto-flight test sequence:

Launch vehicle: __ PUG reference: __

Step	Test	Specification	Duration	Pass Criteria
1	Initial functional test	Full performance baseline	____ hr	All parameters nominal

Step	Test	Specification	Duration	Pass Criteria
2	Sine vibration	___ g, - ___ Hz	___ min/axis x 3	No resonance shift > 5%
3	Random vibration	___ gRMS overall	___ min/axis x 3	No structural damage
4	Post-vibe functional test	Same as step 1	___ hr	Compare to baseline
5	Thermal vacuum -- hot	+ ___ C (predicted max + 10 C)	___ cycles	Functional at hot extreme
6	Thermal vacuum -- cold	- ___ C (predicted min - 10 C)	___ cycles	Functional at cold extreme
7	Post-TVAC functional test	Same as step 1	___ hr	Compare to baseline
8	EMC test	Required? Y / N	___ day	No interference
9	Mass measurement	Calibrated scale (+/- 0.01 kg)	30 min	M <= ___ kg
10	Deployer fit check	___ deployer	2 hr	Fits; slides freely

Total test campaign duration estimate: ___ weeks

Part D: Vibration Test Profile

Record the random vibration PSD profile from your launch vehicle PUG:

Frequency (Hz)	PSD Level (g ² /Hz)	Slope
20		Start
20 - ___		+ ___ dB/oct
- - ___		Flat
___ - 2000		- ___ dB/oct
2000		End

Overall gRMS (calculated): ___ gRMS

Show your calculation:

Part E: TVAC Cycle Profile

Sketch or describe one TVAC cycle:

Hot extreme: + ___ C Cold extreme: - ___ C

Ramp rate: _ C/min Dwell time at extreme: ____ hr

Functional test at each extreme? Y / N Duration of functional test: _____ hr

Calculate time for one cycle:

t_cycle = _____

= _____ hours

Total TVAC campaign: _ cycles x hr + ____ hr setup = _ hr = ____ days

Part F: Waiver Identification

Are there any requirements that cannot be verified by the standard method? Document potential waivers:

Req ID	Standard Method	Proposed Alternative	Justification	Risk

Notes & Reflections

Which environmental test do you consider most critical for your mission? Why?

Worksheet 4.3: Risk, Interfaces & FMECA

Name: _____ Date: ____ Team: _____

Mission Name: _____

Part A: Risk Register

Identify at least 5 technical risks for your mission design. Score each on the 5x5 matrix.

Scoring reminder: L x C = Score. Low (1-4), Medium (5-9), High (10-15), Critical (16-25).

#	Risk Description	L (1-5)	C (1-5)	Score	Category (L/M/H/C)	Mitigation Strategy	Owner (Position)	Post-Mitigation Score
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								

How many risks are High or Critical (before mitigation)? _____

How many remain High or Critical after mitigation? _____

Part B: 5x5 Risk Matrix Plot

Plot your risks on the matrix below. Write the risk number in the appropriate cell.

		Consequence ->				
		1	2	3	4	5
L	5					
i	4					
k	3					
e	2					
l	1					

Part C: N-Squared (N²) Interface Matrix

Fill in the interface matrix for your mission's subsystems. Use abbreviations: - **P** = Power (electrical) - **D** = Data (I2C, SPI, UART, CAN, RS-422) - **R** = RF (coaxial) - **M** = Mechanical (mounting, alignment) - **T** = Thermal (conductive/radiative)

	EPS	OBC	AOCS	TTC	Payload	Structure
EPS	---					
OBC		---				
AOCS			---			
TTC				---		
Payload					---	
Structure						---

Total number of interfaces identified: _____

Interface conflicts detected: (describe at least 2)

1. Conflict: _____

Resolution: _____

1. Conflict: _____

Resolution: _____

Part D: FMECA Table

Complete for 4 critical components:

Component	Function	Failure Mode	Cause	Local Effect	System Effect	Severity (1-5)	Detection Method	Compensating Provision

Part E: Single-Point Failure Analysis

List all single-point failures in your design:

#	Component	Failure Mode	Effect on Mission	SPF?	Acceptable?	Mitigation (if not acceptable)
1				Y/N	Y/N	
2				Y/N	Y/N	
3				Y/N	Y/N	

#	Component	Failure Mode	Effect on Mission	SPF?	Acceptable?	Mitigation (if not acceptable)
4				Y/N	Y/N	
5				Y/N	Y/N	

Total SPFs identified: _ Accepted: *Mitigated*: __

Part F: Reliability Calculation

Calculate the series reliability for your mission's critical chain (components that must all work for mission success):

Component	Individual Reliability (R _i)	Mission Duration Used

$R_{\text{series}} = R_1 \times R_2 \times \dots \times R_n = \text{_____}$

$R_{\text{series}} = \text{_____}$

If you added redundancy to one component (e.g., dual deployment mechanism), recalculate:

$R_{\text{redundant}} = 1 - (1 - R)^2 = 1 - (1 - \text{___})^2 = \text{___}$

New R_{series} (with redundancy) = _____

Improvement: from _ to (+ __ percentage points)

Part G: Risk Discussion

What is the highest-risk item in your design? What would it take (cost, mass, schedule) to bring the risk to an acceptable level?

Notes & Reflections

Which single-point failure concerns you the most? Would you accept it, or is mitigation essential?

Worksheet 4.4: Cost Estimation & Design Review

Name: _____ Date: ____ Team: _____

Mission Name: _____

Part A: Mission Cost Estimate (WBS)

Complete using both parametric estimates (from SpaceCDF Cost tab) and bottom-up estimates (from BOM vendor quotes):

WBS #	Element	Parametric (kEUR)	Bottom-Up (kEUR)	Difference	Notes
1.0	Programme Management				
2.0	Systems Engineering				
3.0	Mission Assurance				
4.0	Payload				
5.0	Spacecraft Bus Hardware				
	5.1 Structure & mechanisms				
	5.2 EPS				
	5.3 AOCS				
	5.4 TTC				
	5.5 OBC & data handling				
	5.6 Thermal				
	5.7 Propulsion				
	5.8 Harness				
6.0	Integration & Test				
7.0	Software (FSW + GSW)				
8.0	Launch Services				
9.0	Ground Segment				
10.0	Operations (____ years)				
	TOTAL	_____	_____		

Part B: Confidence Levels

P50 estimate (your best estimate): _____ kEUR

P70 estimate (P50 x 1.2): _____ kEUR

P80 estimate (P50 x 1.3): _____ kEUR

Show your reasoning for the multiplier (is 1.3 appropriate, or should it be higher for your mission?):

Part C: Constellation Cost (if applicable)

Number of satellites: _ Learning rate: ____%

$b = \ln(\text{learning_rate}) / \ln(2) = \ln(_) / \ln(2) = ___$

Unit #	Unit Cost (kEUR) = $C_1 \times N^b$	Cumulative (kEUR)
1		
2		
4		
8		
_____ (total)		

Show your calculation for the total constellation cost:

Hardware: _ units x kEUR avg = __ kEUR

Spares (_ %): __ units x _ kEUR = ____ kEUR

Launch: _ sats x kEUR = __ kEUR

Ground segment: _____ kEUR

Operations (_ years): ____ kEUR

PM/SE/MA: _____ kEUR

Total constellation cost: _ kEUR = ____ MEUR

P80 constellation cost (x 1.3): _____ MEUR

Part D: Cost Drivers

Top 3 cost drivers in your mission (from SpaceCDF Cost Breakdown):

Rank	Cost Element	Cost (kEUR)	% of Total	Why is it Expensive?
1				
2				
3				

What would you change to reduce total cost by 20%?

Part E: Design Review Readiness

From the SpaceCDF Gate Review tab, assess your readiness for SRR/PDR:

#	Gate Criterion	Status (Pass/Fail/ Manual)	Evidence Location	If Fail: Action Needed
1	Mission need justified			
2	Requirements complete & traceable			
3	All budgets close with margin			
4	Equipment selected (BOM complete)			
5	Interfaces defined, conflicts resolved			
6	V&V approach defined			
7	Risks identified with mitigations			
8	Cost estimate with WBS			
9	ConOps defined			
10	Sustainability compliance			

Must-pass criteria met: _ / ____

Overall readiness: READY / NOT READY

Action items to achieve readiness:

1.
2.
3.

Part F: Presentation Preparation

Outline your 12-minute design review presentation:

Section	Duration	Key Message	Evidence/Data to Show
1. Mission Need	2 min		
2. Why Space?	2 min		
3. System Design	3 min		
4. Equipment & V&V	2 min		

Section	Duration	Key Message	Evidence/Data to Show
5. Risk & Cost	2 min		
6. Operations & Lessons	1 min		

Notes & Reflections

What is the most uncertain element in your cost estimate? How would you reduce the uncertainty?

Worksheet 5.1: Ground Segment & Operations Architecture

Name: _____ Date: ____ Team: _____

Mission Name: _____ Orbit: *km*, ____ deg inclination

Part A: Ground Station Contact Analysis

Calculate contact time and data volume per pass for your mission.

Input Parameters

Parameter	Value	Source
Orbital altitude (h)	_____ km	SpaceCDF orbit selection
Minimum elevation angle (epsilon)	_____ deg	Ground station spec (typically 5-10)
Downlink data rate (R)	_____ Mbps	SpaceCDF link budget
Protocol efficiency (eta)	_____ (typically 0.85-0.95)	CCSDS overhead estimate
Ground station latitude	_____ deg	Selected station
Earth radius (R_E)	6371 km	Constant

Calculations

Maximum slant range:

$$\rho = R_E \times (\sqrt{(h/R_E + 1)^2 - \cos^2(\epsilon)} - \sin(\epsilon))$$

$$\rho = 6371 \times (\sqrt{((_)/6371 + 1)^2 - \cos^2(_)} - \sin(_))$$

$$\rho = \text{_____ km}$$

Average pass duration (approximate):

$$T_{\text{avg}} \sim \text{_____ minutes (from STK/SpaceCDF or estimate: } \sim 6 \text{ min for 500 km SSO)}$$

Data volume per pass:

$$V_{\text{data}} = R \times T \times \eta = _ \text{ Mbps} \times _ \text{ s} \times _ = _ \text{ Mbit} = _ \text{ MB}$$

Part B: Data Budget Closure

Parameter	Value	Unit
Daily data generation (payload)		MB/day
Daily data generation (housekeeping)		MB/day
Total daily generation		MB/day

Parameter	Value	Unit
Passes per day (GS 1: _____)		passes
Data per pass (GS 1)		MB
Subtotal downlink (GS 1)		MB/day
Passes per day (GS 2: _____)		passes
Data per pass (GS 2)		MB
Subtotal downlink (GS 2)		MB/day
Total daily downlink capacity		MB/day
Data budget margin		MB/day
Margin percentage		%

Does the data budget close? Y / N

If not, what changes would close it? (check all that apply)

- ☐ Add another ground station at: ____
- ☐ Increase data rate to: _ **Mbps (requires: _____)**
- ☐ Reduce payload data generation to: _ **MB/day (impact: _____)**
- ☐ Add onboard compression (ratio: _____:1)
- ☐ Use SatNOGS network for additional passes
- ☐ Other: _____

Part C: Ground Station Network Design

Station #	Location	Latitude	Antenna	Band	Data Rate	Passes/Day	Role
1							Primary TTC
2							Payload DL
3							Backup/SatNOGS

Total ground segment cost estimate: _____ kEUR

Cost Element	Annual Cost (kEUR)	Notes
Antenna rental / ownership		
MCS software licence		
Network connectivity		
Operations staff (_____ FTE)		
Total annual		

Cost Element	Annual Cost (kEUR)	Notes
Mission lifetime (____ yr)		

Part D: LEOP Timeline

Construct the LEOP timeline for the first 72 hours after separation:

Time (UTC)	Sim Time	Activity	Success Criterion	Status
T+0	Separation	Deployment switches release		[]
T+30 min	Timer expires	Antenna deployment commanded		[]
T+____		Beacon acquisition	Carrier lock	[]
T+____		First HK telemetry	Data decoded	[]
T+____		First uplink command	ACK received	[]
T+____		SA deployment (if separate)	Power generation confirmed	[]
T+____		ADCS initialisation	Attitude determination active	[]
T+____		ADCS calibration	Pointing < ____ deg	[]
T+____		Full duplex validation	Uplink + downlink at ops rate	[]
T+____		Health assessment complete	All subsystems nominal	[]

Part E: Mission Operations Timeline (Gantt Chart)

Sketch the operations timeline from launch to end of life:

Phase:	LEOP															Commission					Early Ops					Nominal Operations					EOL																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																													
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Notes & Reflections

What is the most challenging aspect of your ground segment design? What would you do differently with more budget?

Worksheet 5.2: Mission Operations Concepts

Name: _____ Date: ____ Team: _____

Mission Name: _____

Part A: Operational Modes

Define all operational modes for your spacecraft. Use the SpaceCDF ConOps Editor to enter these.

Mode	Description	Power (W)	Data Rate	Entry Condition	Exit Condition
Safe					
Detumble					
Standby					
Science					
Downlink					
Eclipse					
Manoeuvre					

Verify: Does the power budget close in every mode?

Mode	Power Consumption (W)	Power Available (W)	Margin (W)	Closes?
Safe				Y / N
Detumble				Y / N
Standby				Y / N
Science				Y / N
Downlink				Y / N
Eclipse (battery only)				Y / N

Part B: FDIR Rules

Define at least 5 FDIR rules for your spacecraft:

#	Fault Description	Detection Method	Threshold	FDIR Level (0-4)	Autonomous Response	Recovery Procedure
1						
2						

#	Fault Description	Detection Method	Threshold	FDIR Level (0-4)	Autonomous Response	Recovery Procedure
3						
4						
5						
6						

Can Safe Mode sustain the spacecraft indefinitely (power + thermal)? Y / N

If not, what is the maximum Safe Mode duration? _____ hours

Can every autonomous FDIR action be overridden from ground? Y / N

If not, which cannot? _____

Part C: Nominal Procedure

Write one nominal procedure for your mission (science observation or data downlink):

Procedure ID: ____ Title: _____

Preconditions:

Step	Action	Expected Result	If Not Achieved
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Post-conditions:

Part D: Contingency Procedure

Write one contingency procedure (e.g., safe mode recovery, communication loss recovery):

Procedure ID: ____ Title: _____

Trigger condition:

Severity level: Green / Yellow / Orange / Red

Step	Action	Expected Result	If Not Achieved	Timeout
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

Escalation: If this procedure fails, escalate to: _____

Post-conditions:

Part E: Operations Staffing

Estimate the staffing requirements for each mission phase:

Phase	Duration	Shifts/Day	Staff/Shift	Total FTE	Annual Cost (kEUR)
LEOP	_____ days	3 (24/7)			
Commissioning	_____ weeks	2 (16/7)			
Early Operations	_____ months	1 (8/5)			
Nominal Operations	_____ years	1 (8/5) or auto			
End of Life	_____ weeks	1 (8/5)			
Total					

Part F: Anomaly Scenario

Hypothetical scenario: Your satellite enters Safe Mode during a weekend. The next ground contact is Monday morning (40 hours away). Walk through your response:

1. What is the spacecraft doing in Safe Mode?

1. Will it survive 40 hours? (Check power and thermal)

1. What telemetry will you review first on Monday?

1. What is your recovery plan?

Notes & Reflections

How much autonomy should your spacecraft have? Where is the line between onboard decision-making and ground control?

Worksheet 5.3: Mission Simulation Day

Name: _____ Date: ____ Team: _____

Mission Name: _____

Your Role: _____ (FD / SC / GSO / PO / FD-nav / Logger)

Simulation Event Log

Record ALL events, decisions, and actions in real-time during the simulation:

#	Sim Time	Real Time	Event / Observation	Action Taken	Result	Logged By
1	T+0		Separation			
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						
13						
14						
15						
16						
17						
18						
19						
20						

LEOP Checklist

Check off each LEOP milestone as it is achieved during the simulation:

#	Milestone	Time Achieved	Status	Notes
1	Separation confirmed		☐	
2	30-min timer expired		☐	
3	Antenna deployed		☐	
4	Beacon acquired		☐	
5	First HK telemetry decoded		☐	
6	First uplink command ACK'd		☐	
7	Solar array deployed (if sep.)		☐	
8	ADCS detumble complete		☐	
9	ADCS calibration complete		☐	
10	Full duplex validated		☐	
11	All subsystems nominal		☐	

Anomaly Response Form 1

Complete this form for each injected anomaly during the simulation.

Field	Entry
Anomaly ID	ANO-SIM-001
Sim Time	
Real Time	
Severity	Green / Yellow / Orange / Red
Affected Subsystem	

Observation (exact telemetry values and symptoms):

Initial Assessment (what do you think happened?):

Diagnosis (root cause after investigation):

Action Taken (commands sent, procedures executed):

Step	Time	Action	Expected Result	Actual Result
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

Final Result (system state after response):

Follow-up Required:

Procedure used: ___ **Did it work as written?** Y / N / Partially

If not, what changes are needed? _____

Anomaly Response Form 2

Field	Entry
Anomaly ID	ANO-SIM-002
Sim Time	
Real Time	
Severity	Green / Yellow / Orange / Red
Affected Subsystem	

Observation (exact telemetry values and symptoms):

Initial Assessment (what do you think happened?):

Diagnosis (root cause after investigation):

Action Taken (commands sent, procedures executed):

Step	Time	Action	Expected Result	Actual Result
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

Final Result (system state after response):

Follow-up Required:

Procedure used: ___ Did it work as written? Y / N / Partially

If not, what changes are needed? _____

Anomaly Response Form 3

Field	Entry
Anomaly ID	ANO-SIM-003
Sim Time	
Real Time	
Severity	Green / Yellow / Orange / Red
Affected Subsystem	

Observation (exact telemetry values and symptoms):

Initial Assessment:

Diagnosis:

Action Taken:

Step	Time	Action	Expected Result	Actual Result
1				
2				
3				
4				

Final Result:

Procedure used: ___ Did it work as written? Y / N / Partially

Commissioning Status

After the commissioning phase of the simulation, record subsystem checkout status:

Subsystem	Checkout Complete?	Performance vs Spec	Issues Found
EPS	[]	Nominal / Degraded / Failed	
OBC	[]	Nominal / Degraded / Failed	
AOCS	[]	Nominal / Degraded / Failed	
TTC	[]	Nominal / Degraded / Failed	
Thermal	[]	Nominal / Degraded / Failed	
Payload	[]	Nominal / Degraded / Failed	
Propulsion	[]	Nominal / Degraded / Failed / NA	

Nominal Operations Summary

After the nominal operations phase, record:

Metric	Planned	Actual (Simulated)	Variance
Science observations completed			
Data downlinked (MB)			
Anomalies encountered			
Ground contacts made			
Safe mode entries			

Simulation Debrief

What went well?

What could be improved?

Design weaknesses revealed by simulation:

Procedure changes needed:

FDIR gaps identified:

Notes & Reflections

What was the most stressful moment during the simulation? What did it teach you about operations?

Worksheet 5.4: Final Review & Presentations

Name: _____ Date: ____ Team: _____

Mission Name: _____

Part A: Final Design Summary

Record the final state of your design from the SpaceCDF Dashboard:

Parameter	Value	Unit	Margin	Margin %	Status (G/A/R)
Dry mass		kg			
Wet mass (if propulsion)		kg			
SA power (EOL)		W			
Battery capacity		Wh			
Link margin (worst case)		dB			
Pointing accuracy		deg			
Data balance		MB/day			
Total cost (P50)		kEUR			
Total cost (P80)		kEUR			
Debris compliance score		/100			
Mission lifetime		years			

Do all budgets close? Y / N If not, which fail? _____

Number of unresolved conflicts: _____

Part B: Documentation Checklist

Tick each document generated from SpaceCDF Exports tab:

Document	Generated?	Complete?	Notes
MRD (Mission Requirements Document)	☐	☐	
Technical Specification	☐	☐	
Verification Plan	☐	☐	
ConOps Document	☐	☐	
SEMP (Systems Engineering Mgmt Plan)	☐	☐	
IRD (Interface Requirements Document)	☐	☐	

Document	Generated?	Complete?	Notes
Risk Management Plan	☐	☐	
Test Plan	☐	☐	
Bill of Materials	☐	☐	
ITU Filing Template	☐	☐	
RSSA Filing	☐	☐	
Export Control Assessment	☐	☐	
End-of-Life Report	☐	☐	
COPUOS Registration	☐	☐	

Total documents generated: _____ / 14

Part C: Presentation Outline

Prepare your 12-minute final design review presentation:

Section	Time	Key Points to Cover	Evidence / Data to Show
1. Mission Need	2 min		
2. Why Space?	2 min		
3. System Design	3 min		
4. Equipment & V&V	2 min		
5. Risk & Cost	2 min		
6. Operations & Lessons	1 min		

Presenter(s): _____

Backup slides prepared on: _____

Part D: Peer Review Evaluation

Complete this section while reviewing another team's presentation.

Team being reviewed: _____

Reviewers: _____

#	Criterion	Score (0-2)	Comments / Questions
1	Mission need clearly justified		
2	Requirements complete and traceable		
3	All budgets close with margin		

#	Criterion	Score (0-2)	Comments / Questions
4	Equipment selected with justified trades		
5	Interfaces defined, conflicts resolved		
6	V&V approach defined		
7	Risks identified with mitigations		
8	Cost estimate with WBS and P80		
9	ConOps and ground segment designed		
10	Sustainability compliance		
	TOTAL	/ 20	

Presentation quality:

Criterion	Score (1-5)	Comments
Clarity of communication		
Use of evidence (data, not assertions)		
Ability to answer questions		
Time management		

Board recommendation: GO / NO GO / GO WITH ACTIONS**Action items for the presenting team:**

#	Action	Responsible	Deadline
1			
2			
3			

Strongest aspect of this team's design:

Biggest area for improvement:

Part E: Lessons Learned**1. What was the most challenging design decision your team faced?**

1. What would you do differently if starting the course over?

1. What does the design need next (Phase B activities)?

1. What was the most valuable SpaceCDF feature?

1. What feature was missing that you needed?

1. What concept from this course will you apply in your future work?

Part F: Self-Assessment Rubric

Rate your own learning across the three weeks of the course. Be honest -- this is for your own reflection, not grading.

Competency	Week 1 Start (1-5)	Now (1-5)	Evidence of Growth
Define a space mission starting from the problem, not the solution			
Write verifiable, traceable requirements (SMART format)			
Conduct a structured trade study with weighted criteria			
Size subsystems using parametric models and engineering budgets			
Select COTS equipment and verify interface compatibility			
Construct a verification matrix with IADT methods			
Assess risk using a 5x5 matrix and define mitigations			
Estimate mission cost using parametric and bottom-up methods			
Design a ground segment and calculate data budget			
Define operational modes, FDIR rules, and procedures			
Respond to anomalies using a systematic process			

Competency	Week 1 Start (1-5)	Now (1-5)	Evidence of Growth
Present a design to a review board with evidence			

Scale: 1 = No familiarity, 2 = Basic awareness, 3 = Can apply with guidance, 4 = Can apply independently, 5 = Can teach others

Overall self-assessment:

At the start of this course, I would describe my systems engineering ability as:

Now, I would describe it as:

One thing I am most proud of from this course:

Notes & Reflections

Final thoughts on the course, the design process, and what comes next: